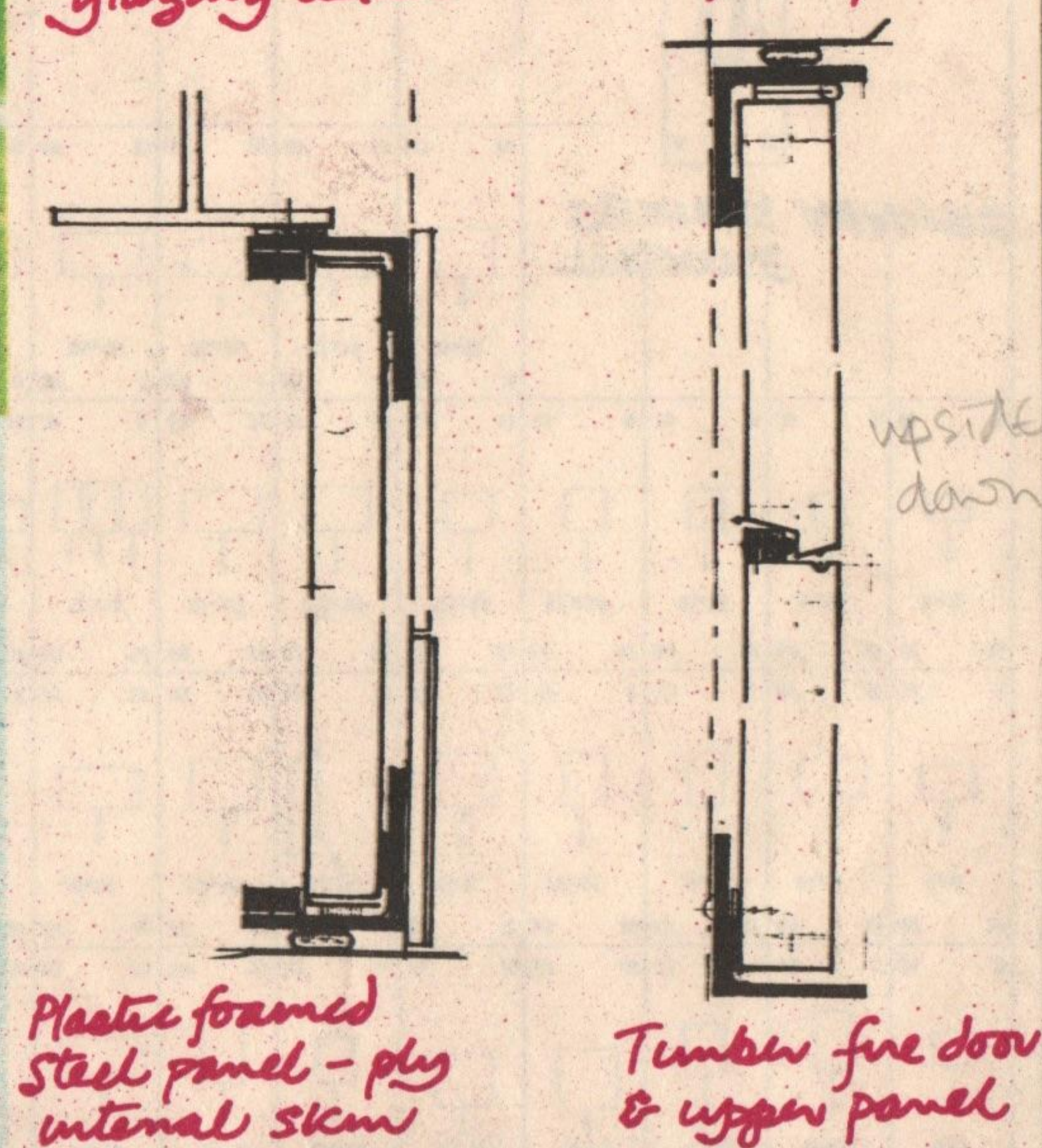
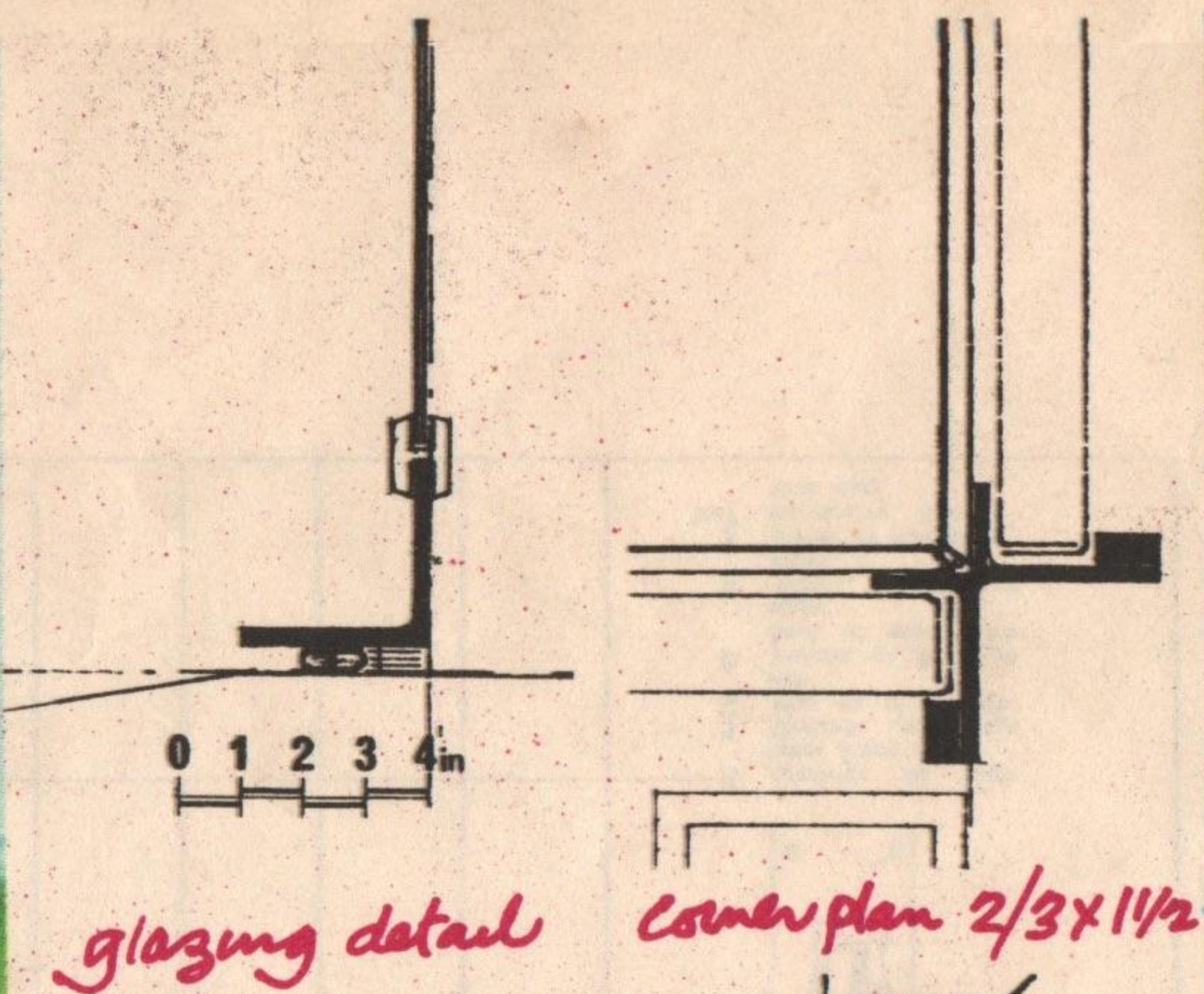
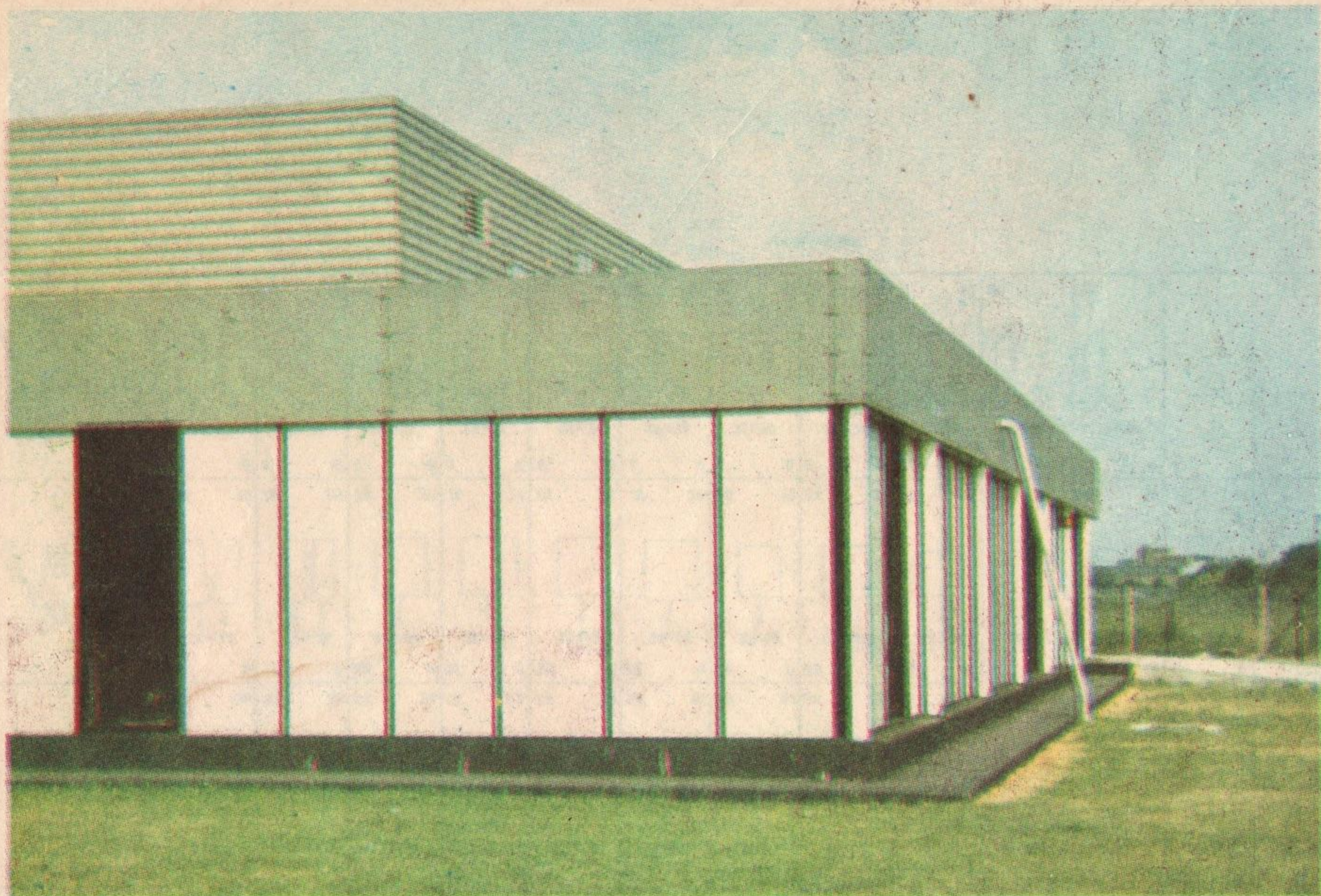




3" x 3" R.S. angle used throughout
skin with neoprene gaskets/seals.

A 'negative' definition

Additive detailing consists of the addition of elements, whose dimensional accuracy, durability, material and/or function is such that were they to be combined in a more complex way with other elements of a similar range of usefulness, would in themselves inhibit in dimensional stability or range of tolerances that they themselves command. Additive detailing can include small structural elements and enormous socio/volumetric elements. See also 64/63/AB.5 and X15/62/32/A.15

THE SECOND INSTALMENT IN THE CEDRIC PRICE SUPPLEMENT SERIES

(See also AD 10/70.)

68

88

A4a

18

14

Computer Centre.

Completed April 1969
(See also AD 10/69)

ECHOES
Medium

A compact fully air-conditioned artificially lit sheet steel box for the British Transport Docks Board. A major (20% by area) extension of both the building and the computer is envisaged during the life of the building. Thus the total frame, floor and cladding have to be capable of extension while causing minimal interference to the 24 hour computer activity. The internal partitions and external skin had to be capable of variation both before and after any such extension to facilitate frequent internal re-organisation. Thus the external wall detailing is of an *additive* form enabling interchange of opaque and transparent panels. This is achieved externally while the removeable internal ply panel provides the temporary weather seal during such interchange. The whole Fire Escape door assembly can be re-located as required. Being bottom hung it falls out to form a gangway down to ground level.

Comment

The alternative of a sealed transparent skin with variable insulated (thermal and acoustic) internal panels still interests me. In either case I assumed that it should be easier to give a secretary another window to look out of than to move her desk — and thereby others. Gravity controlled fire escape systems always seem a good idea eg counter-weighted external fire stairs on U.S. tenements.

- | | |
|-----|---|
| A | Distance to stage from front row |
| B | Distance to stage |
| C | Max. no. of seats per row |
| D | Height of front of bank of seats from stage |
| X | Width parallel to stage |
| Y | Depth of seat bank |
| XxY | Represents lno. unit only |

66

80

AD5

20

12

Port Eliot, Cornwall

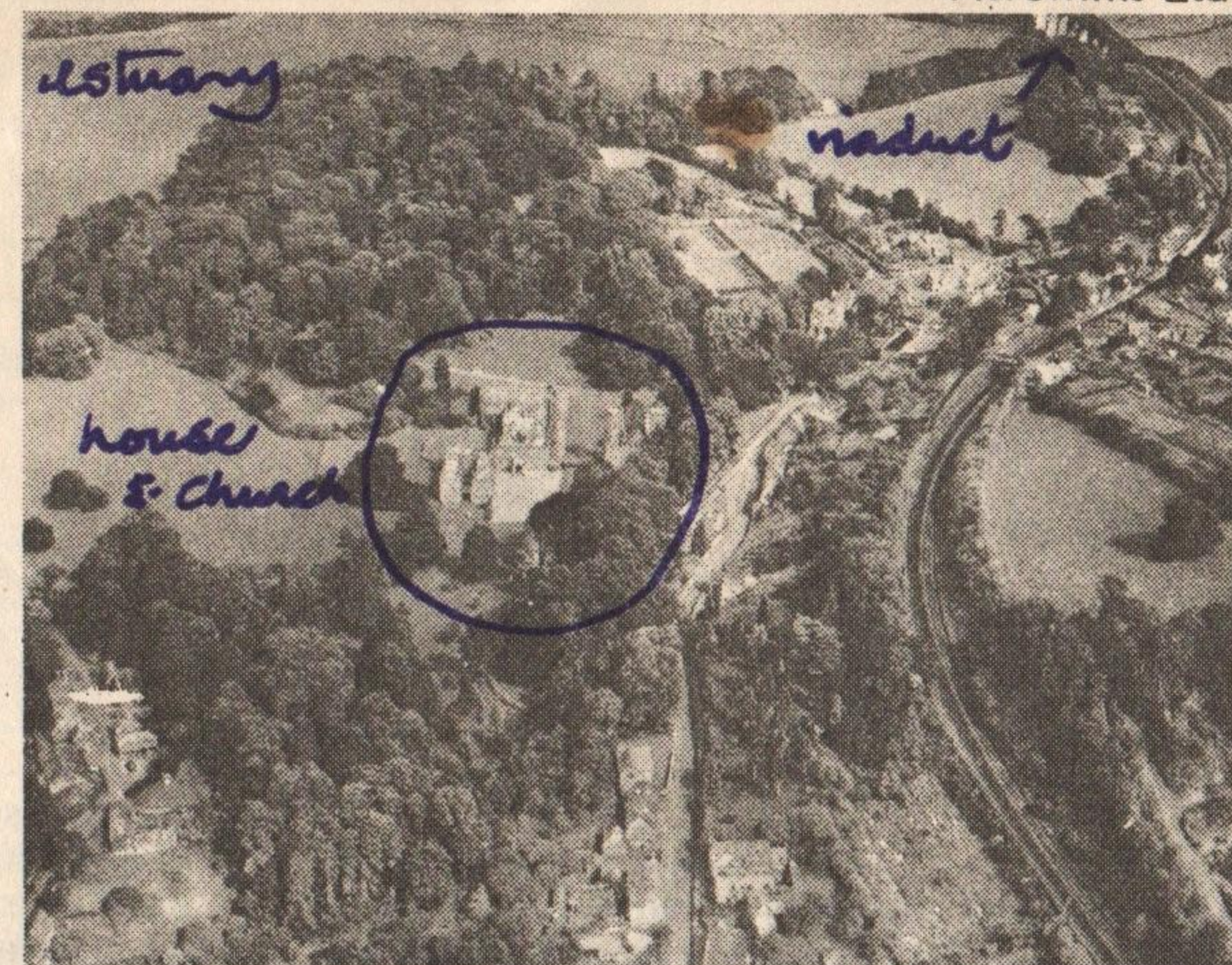
A comprehensive study for the long term development of a private estate and occupied house. The brief written by C.P. and agreed by the client was "that any plan for . . . must primarily increase the enjoyment and delight of the total property while in no way reducing its effectiveness as an agricultural unit". The proposals were to relate to the estate, gardens, buildings and the house and to encompass both private and private/tourism usage. It was intended that the major portion of the labour required would be locally available. Much of the extremely detailed landscaping designed by Repton 1802 has already passed its prime. The house is medieval, early Georgian, remodelled by Soane and finished off by Harrison 1829. The proximity of Plymouth and the fact that the major holiday/pleasure road route to the West bordered the estate was considered. Port Eliot has been occupied by the same family since 1564.

As a result of a survey of both park and house the illustrated proposals were made to be achieved over a 10 year span (Details in Port Eliot Potential Report CP 1966)

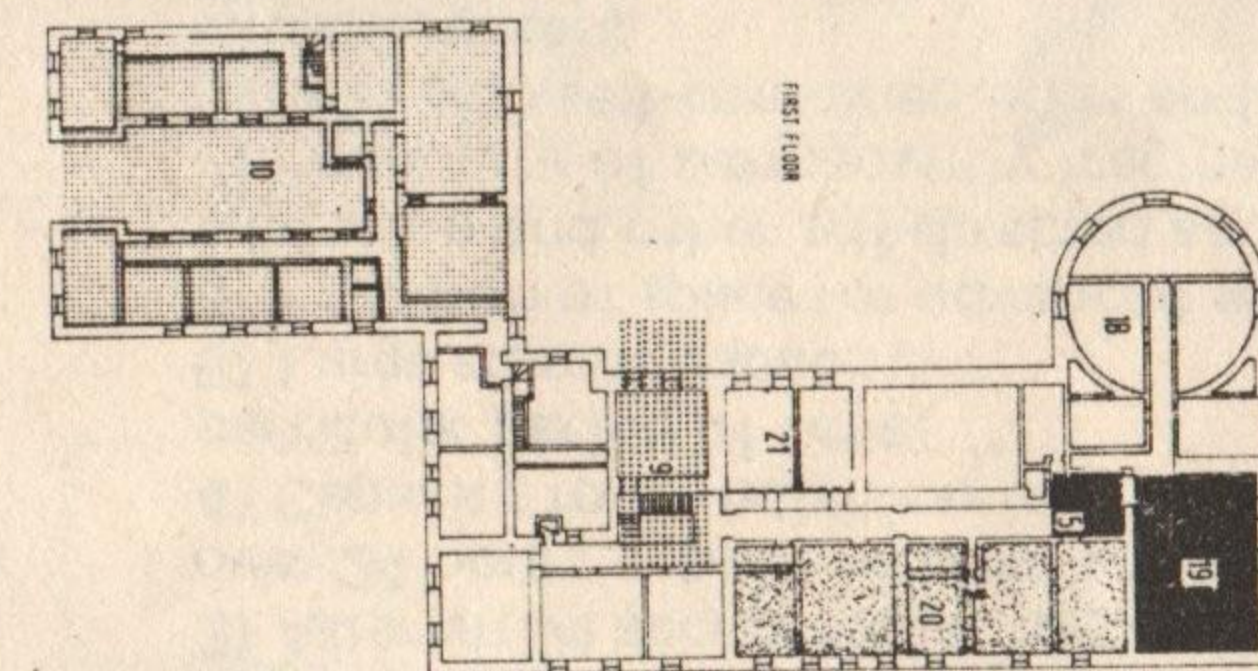
Comment

Parkland proposals I think very good. While many of the generous house proposals are being adopted, ie 40' diameter main bedroom etc., no major demolition of the house is now proposed, as the house as found, including mock baronial victorian entrance suite, is being utilised in an extremely appropriate way. The easing up of access to this enormous pile has justified its bulk — so watch it you spatial economists, like me!

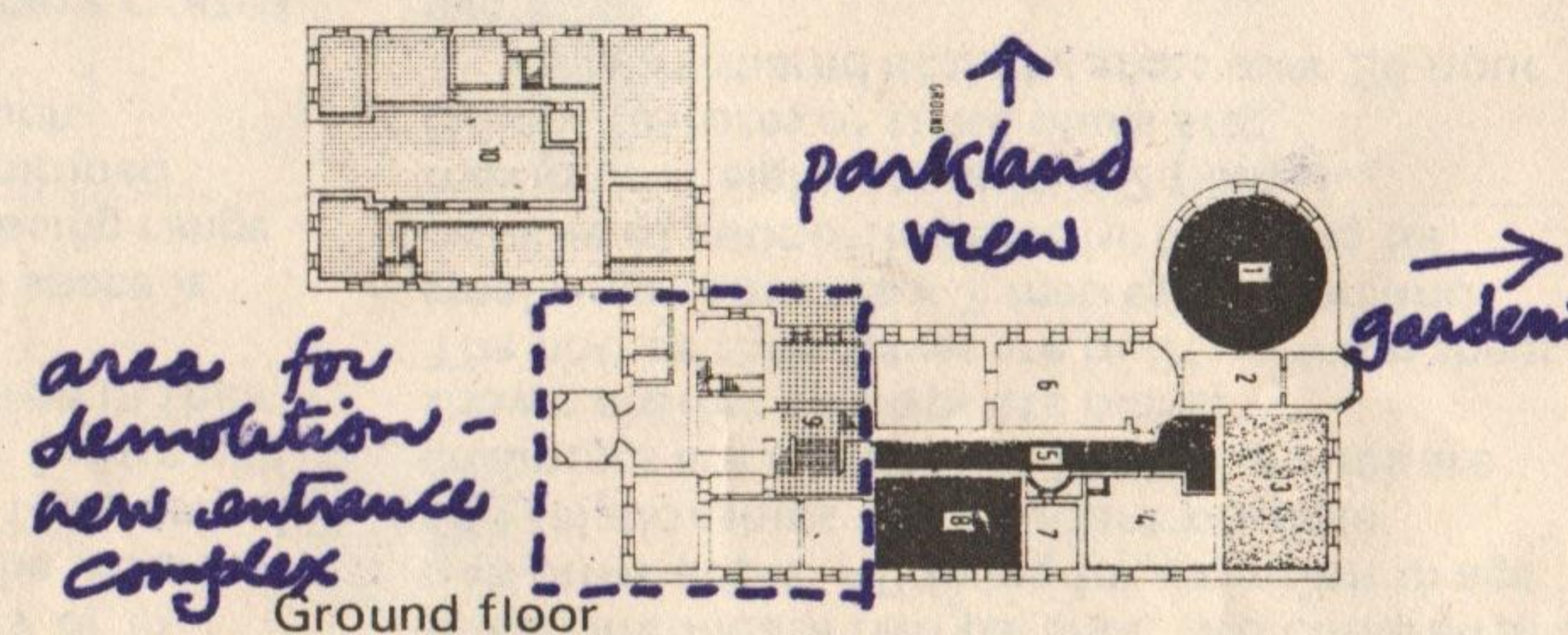
P.S. Even I think some medieval scars are worth just scratching — particularly if controlled by an intelligent client.



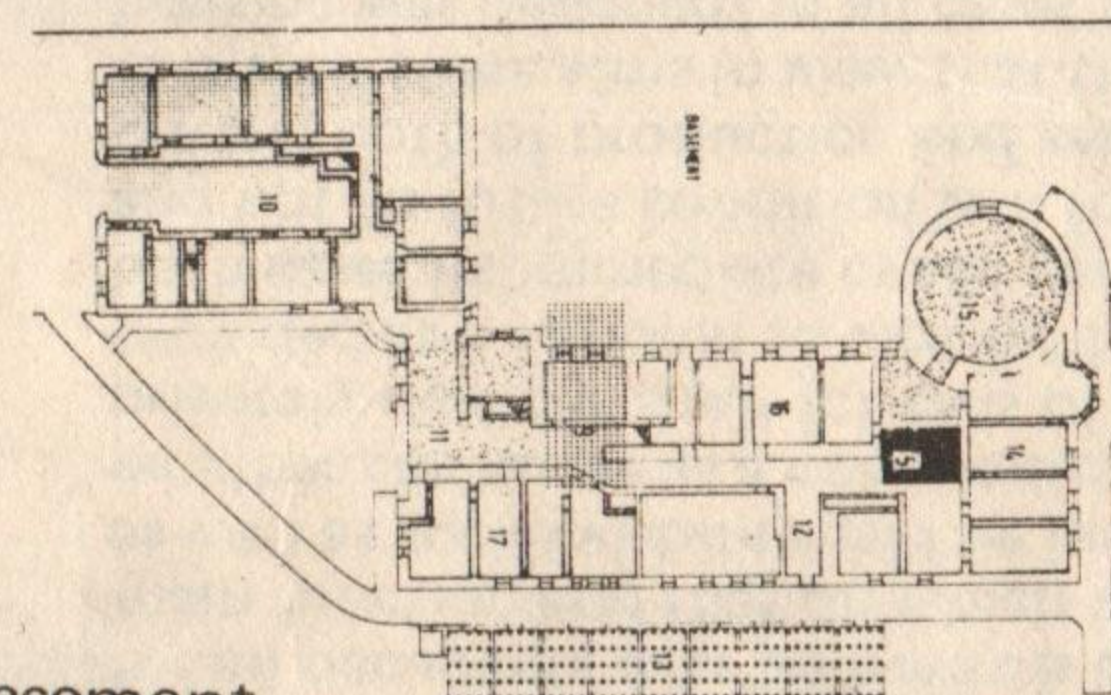
Aerial view of site



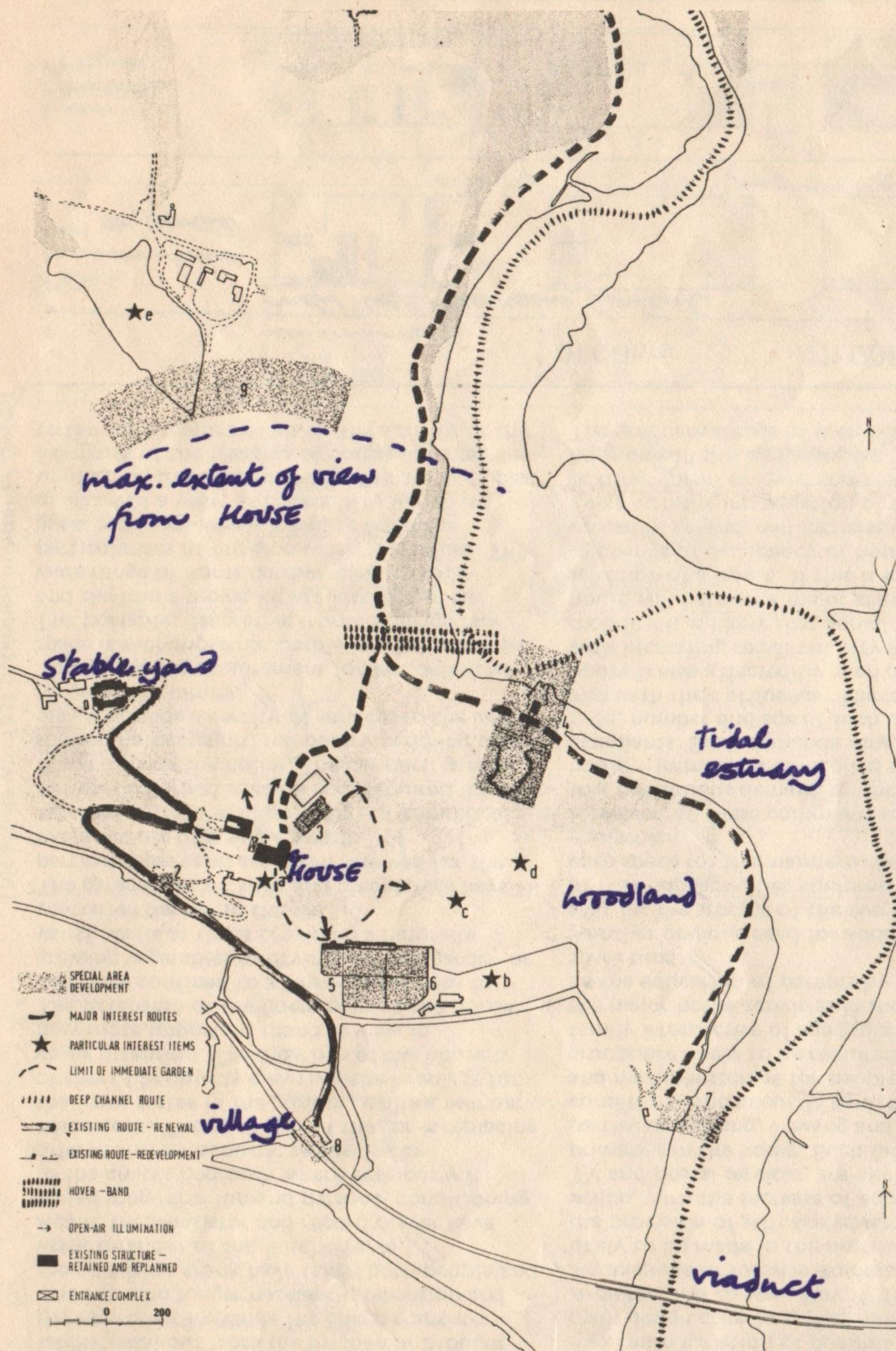
First Floor



Ground floor



Basement



Site Plan

Key to park proposal: a. Developed excavation/museum content. b. Development of vegetable garden. c + d. Development of existing particular planting. 1. Estate management — exhibition area. 2. Gatehouse information service. 3. Pool-temporary cover summerhouse. 4. Quarry, fun ropeway, boat house and water complex. 5. Garden and Orangery formal party area and temporary shelter. 6. Rose gardens — fine weather controlled activities. 7. Access to trad. river

craft-leisure area. 8. Terminal passenger feed-rail. 9. New entrance complex.

Key to house proposal: 1. Major family living room. 2. Direct link internal and external. 3. Initially — large number eating area — later, major childrens' room. 4. Increase of reading and reference facilities. 5. Special equipment and storage linear service zone. 6. Living museum and/or private promenade. 7. Central

maintenance store short term preparation/storage. 8. Use to develop through use with increase of cloakrooms. 5 + 9. Access to 1st floor. 9. short term vehicular shelter. 10. Childrens work/sleep room. 12. Kitchen. 17. Childrens workshops. 19. Nursery and childrens rooms. 20. Guest suites 3 no. 21. Sick room/long stay guests. 13. Storage for estate and childrens' vehicles, sports and garden equipment. 14. Major family workshop area. 16. Staff suite. 18. Main bedroom suite.

INTENTIONS, Aims

Despite lack of public or governmental realisation that housing is rapidly becoming a consumable commodity, the reality of this comparatively new role is a major motivational force in the individual's and the family's use of the house.

THE HOUSE IS NO LONGER ACCEPTABLE AS A PRE-SET ORDERING MECHANISM FOR FAMILY LIFE

To some extent occupants have always reacted against the house as found but this has largely been confined to the changing of the wall-paper, or, if privileged, the garden gate.

The single family radio set often drew the family meal out from the kitchen or brought the easy chair in. While the cheap transistor made this no longer necessary, television and the television snack have taken both people and work time out of the 'kitchen area.'

Again, the transistor and record player have added long-term fun and personal conditioning to the child's bedroom where previously it offered merely acoustic seclusion for homework. The back seat of the car is replacing the front settee in the parlour, while a number of short-life objects now rival the fireplace for visual attention. The view out of the house is now more important than the view in.

The extension of the home beyond the house was once confined to a fine-weather area for growing vegetables or drying clothes (garden or yard), while at times providing a naturally ventilated barrier to the wc.

The garage, garden shed and greenhouse have all particular uses and are often reserved for the exclusive use of a single person.

However, an increasing amount of communal, less-particularised space is now required for the home outside the house. The car-port, garden shelter, barbecue pit, temporary paddling pool, etc all provide a variety of services to the whole range of the family.

This increasing requirement for less definitive space is even more noticeable inside the house. The portable, decorative fronted refrigerator and the home movie-kit are just two of the wide range of home hardware which only particularises its position when it is in use. The guest bedroom which is empty for three quarters of a year, or the scullery which is unused for three quarters of a day are both past examples of the freezing of usable volumes due to the static nature of either the activity or the

equipment associated with such volumes.

Now, with space being at a greater premium than hardware, the permanent grouping together of domestic equipment for the convenience of the plumber or the ventilating engineer is likely to become an increasing restrictive element of the domestic plan, generating, as it does, a radial sequence of spaces directly related to such a core. Any increase in a particular space automatically increases the distance from the core.

However, with the fragmentation of services and miniaturisation and mobilisation of equipment, the provision of space with a maximum variation of possible use becomes the main design criterion. (For more details, see *Architectural Design*, May, 1967).

An example of massive domestic space demands likely to be made in the near future is that for the provision of selfpace educational facilities, which, with the increase of educational radio, TV and postal services, are likely to be based primarily in the home. Such facilities requiring particular lighting, viewing and display conditions, and acoustic control or shielding, and multiple storage for people singly or in groups are likely to be required by the whole family irrespective of age groups. In fact, one of the major home activities in the near future will be the education of parents by children in their spare time.

Another obvious need for additional space is that for the storage of the ever-increasing range of free-time activities equipment combined with space for the maintenance of such equipment.

However, all these comments so far have related to a continuous demand on the home (ie house + immediate controlled surround) by its occupants. Such demands vary, of course, with type, number and age of such occupants, and also with their affluence. The location of the house is also affected by such demands, and with increasing social security and personal mobility it is likely that actual location of the house will become a major criterion in the selection of a house. If this is so, then the rate of change of occupancy of houses, whether owned or rented, will increase even further.

Even with the introduction of the mobile home or other forms of fixed short-life housing, such housing will still be judged by the same criteria. The great advantage of such housing is that, due

to its short life, its original appeal is likely to diminish less by the end of its life than that of present-day 60-80 year houses. For just the same reason the likelihood of creating modern slums will be reduced.

However, in all these cases, as householders become increasingly prepared to change their houses for locational reasons and personal reasons such as affluence or old age, then the role of a house as a long-term adaptable living-box becomes less important than its 24-hour cycle performance as an economic living-toy. That is, the capacity for the house to enrich possible and desirable activity patterns for all occupants over 24 hours is becoming its main function and that on which its economic as well as social viability will be judged. For whether the house as a commodity is bought privately over the shelf (cf cans of soup) or provided as a national service (cf false teeth), in both cases its immediate cyclic performance and not its future condition will form the criteria both of production and selection.

It is with these aims in view that the illustrated housing was designed. In all cases the plans are to accommodate two parents, two children and one other adult. Allowing for variation in age and relationships the resultant possible groupings are numerous. Typical groups are shown against appropriate plans.

The houses themselves are built up from sheet steel rings 2 metres x 7 metres on plan and capable of supporting one further ring (ie maximum height possible is 2 floors).

Salient features of these plans are:

- 1) Variable shared activity areas over 24-hour cycle.
- 2) Fragmented cleansing services.
- 3) Alternative access routes to particular areas over 24 hours — both internal and external.
- 4) Capacity for subdivision into 2 'homes' for a particular period of time.
- 5) Large storage capacity.
- 6) Provision of space for advanced self-pace education and other self-directed activities.
- 7) Possibility of permanently fragmented 'home' with self-contained units and separate external access.
- 8) Acoustic conditioning re-inforced by cyclical spatial separation of quiet areas.
- 9) Capacity for improvement or replacement of cleansing and cooking plant.

67

X15

D35

21

X

24 hour Living Toy

A development of the steel house competition entry (AD 11 67) and a generator of the present Short Life Housing. The designs are intended to enable an increase in the frequency and particularisation of individuals personal servicing (urinating, making love etc) through a separation of necessary physical zoning through a 24 hour cycle rather than a L.C.D. form of slovenly overdesigning *insulating* and *sterilizing* all available areas on the off-chance of something happening anywhere sometime. (c.f. Bernard Shaw's definition (roughly) of a modern house: *Somewhere to sleep next to the car.*

Comment

The areas are still too indicative of traditional living, cooking, sleeping areas à la NBA (What is a generic house plan, anyhow?) Slightly posh breakdown of likely 5 person habitation groups.

This article was first published in *Interior Design*

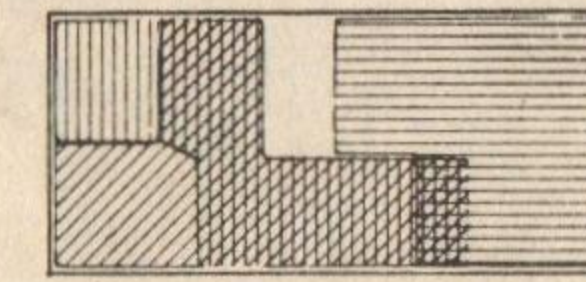
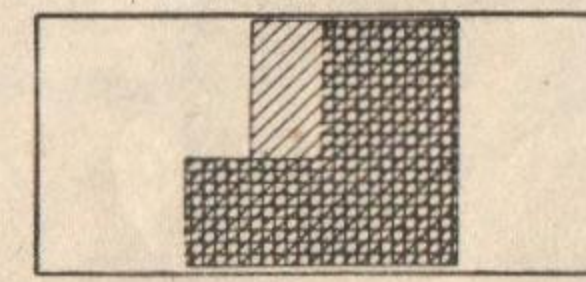
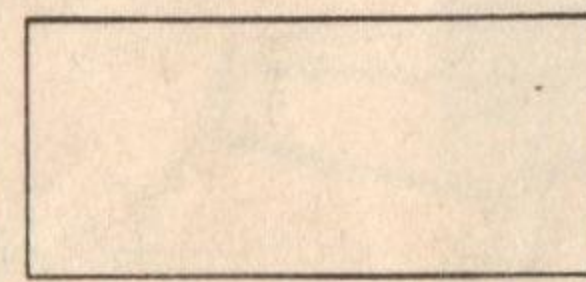
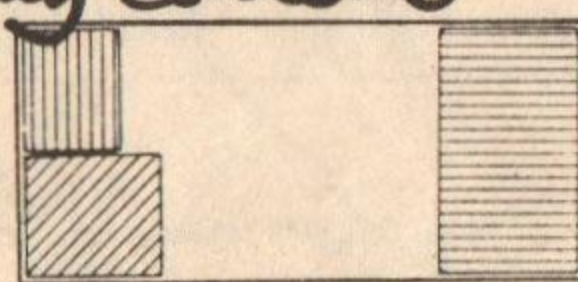
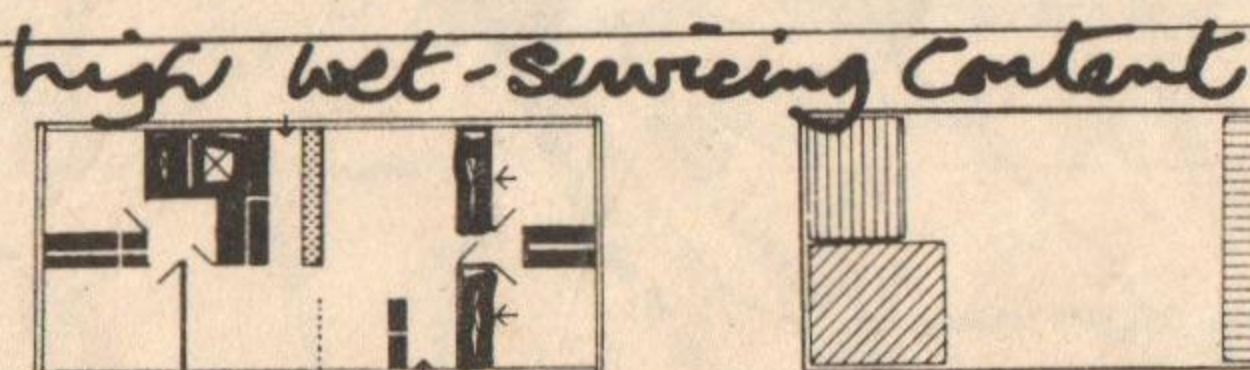
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11.00hrs

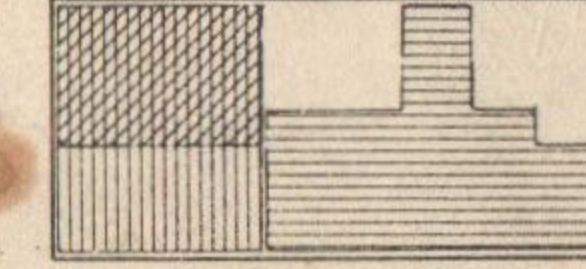
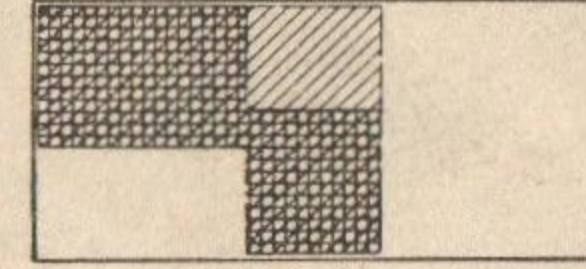
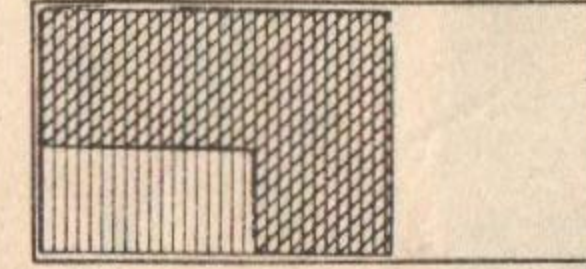
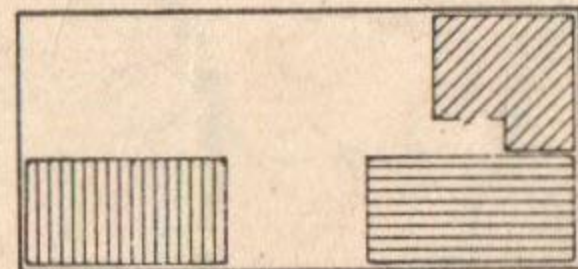
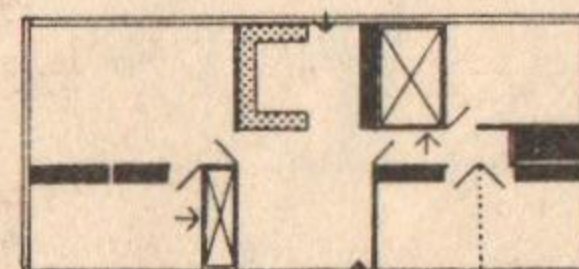
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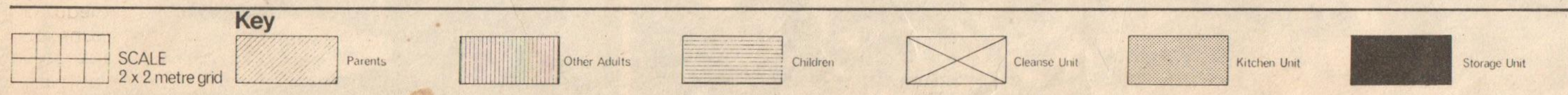
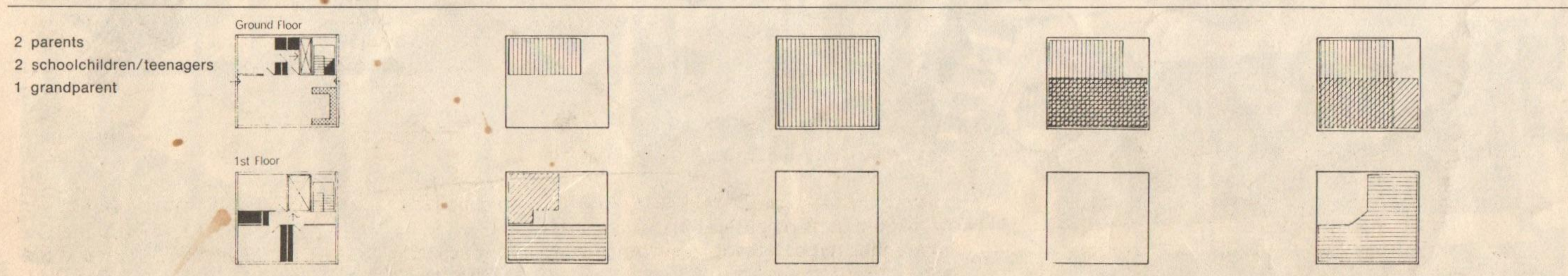
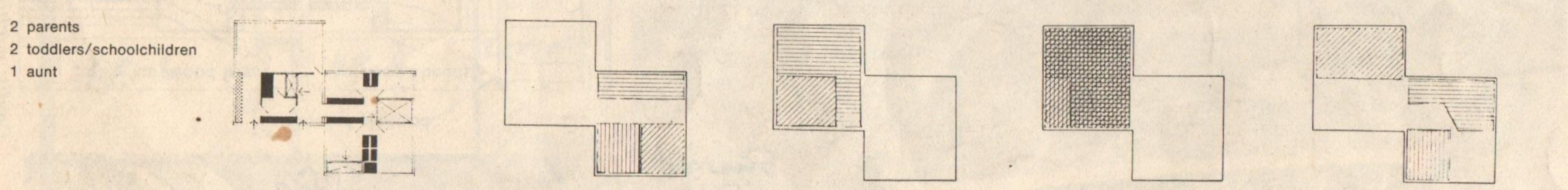
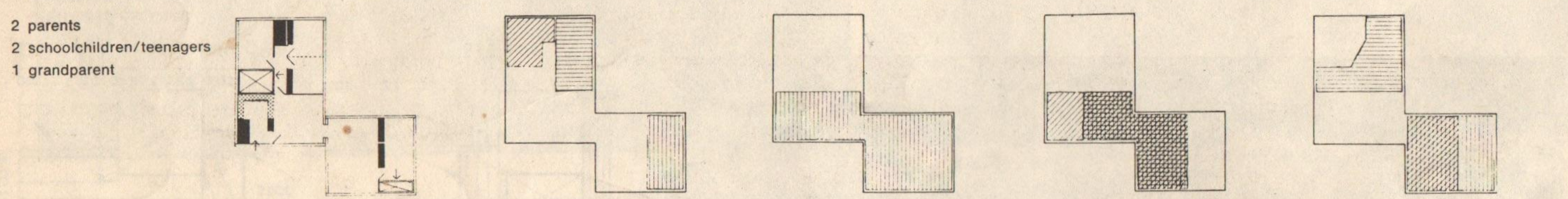
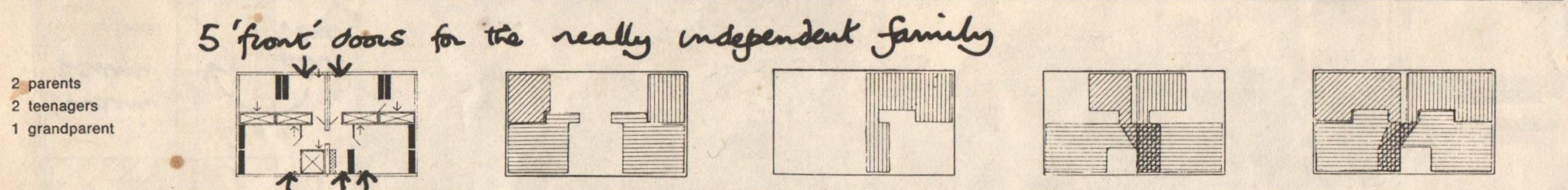
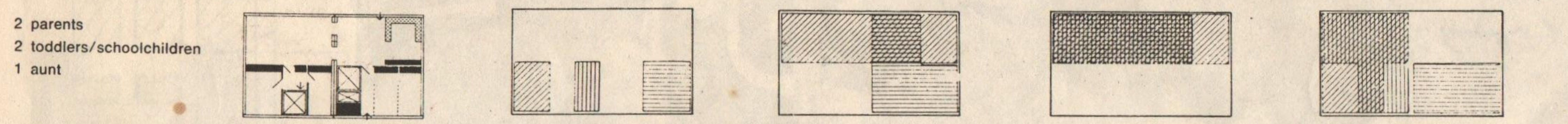
22.00hrs

2 parents
2 schoolchildren/teenagers
1 aunt
a uncle



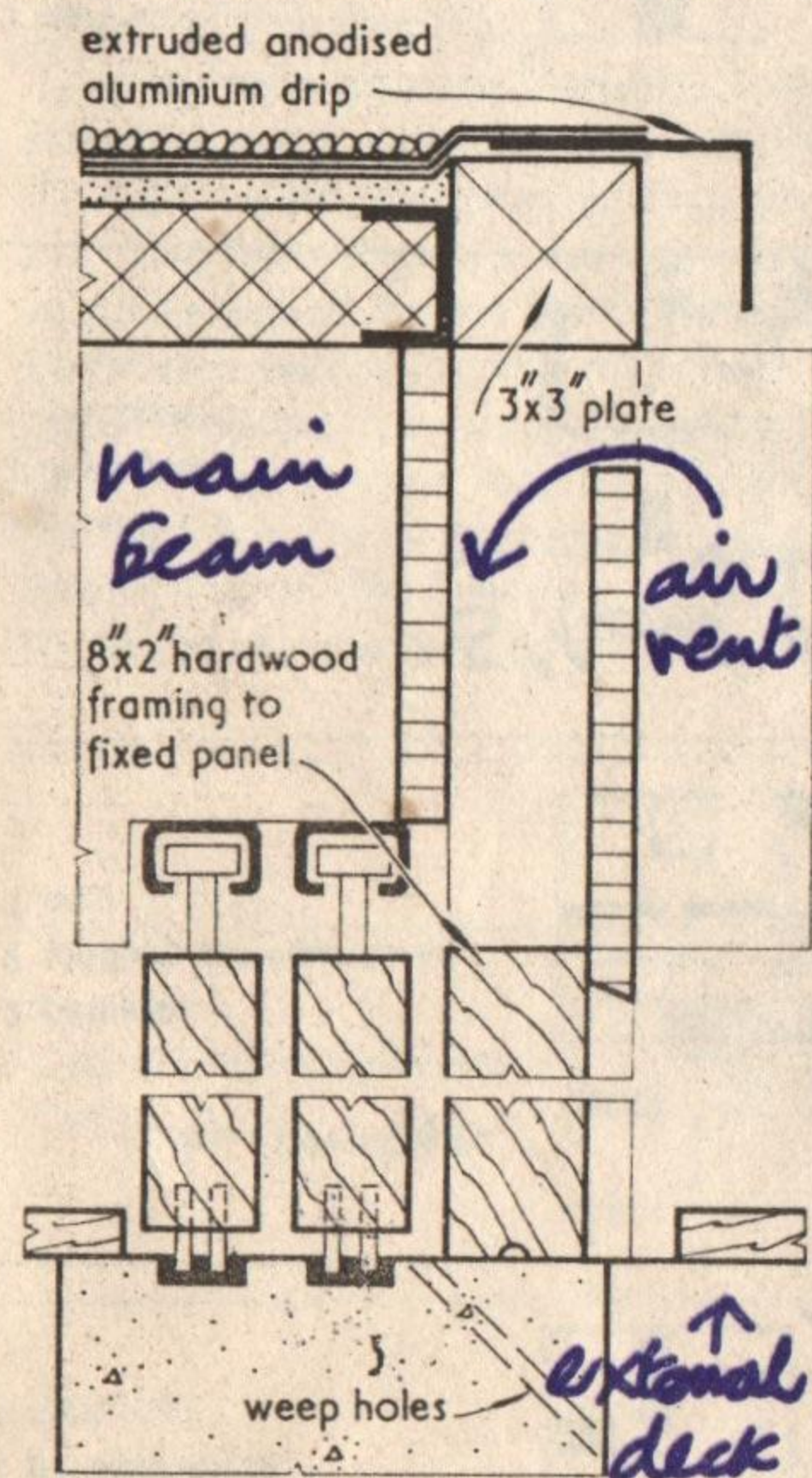
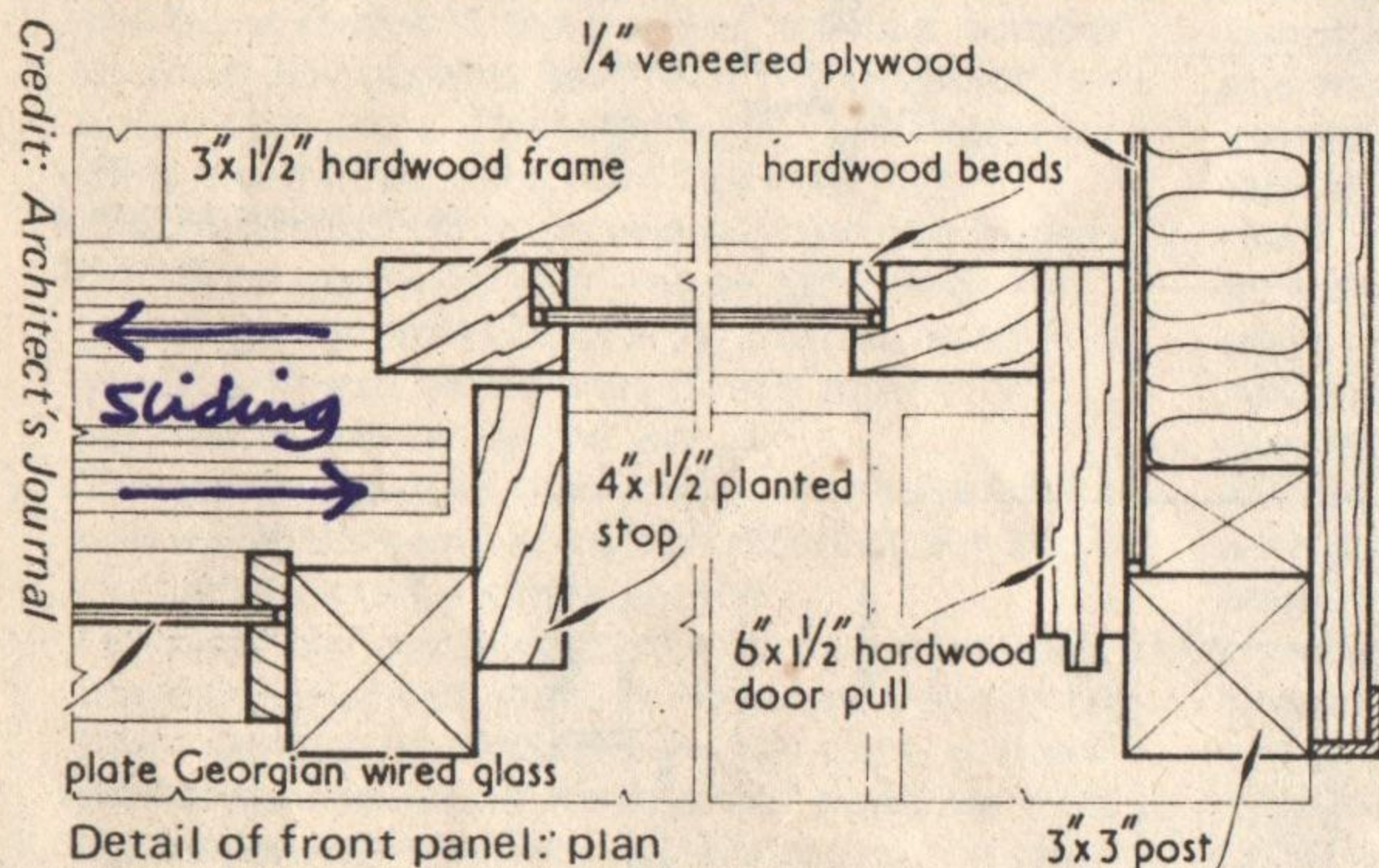
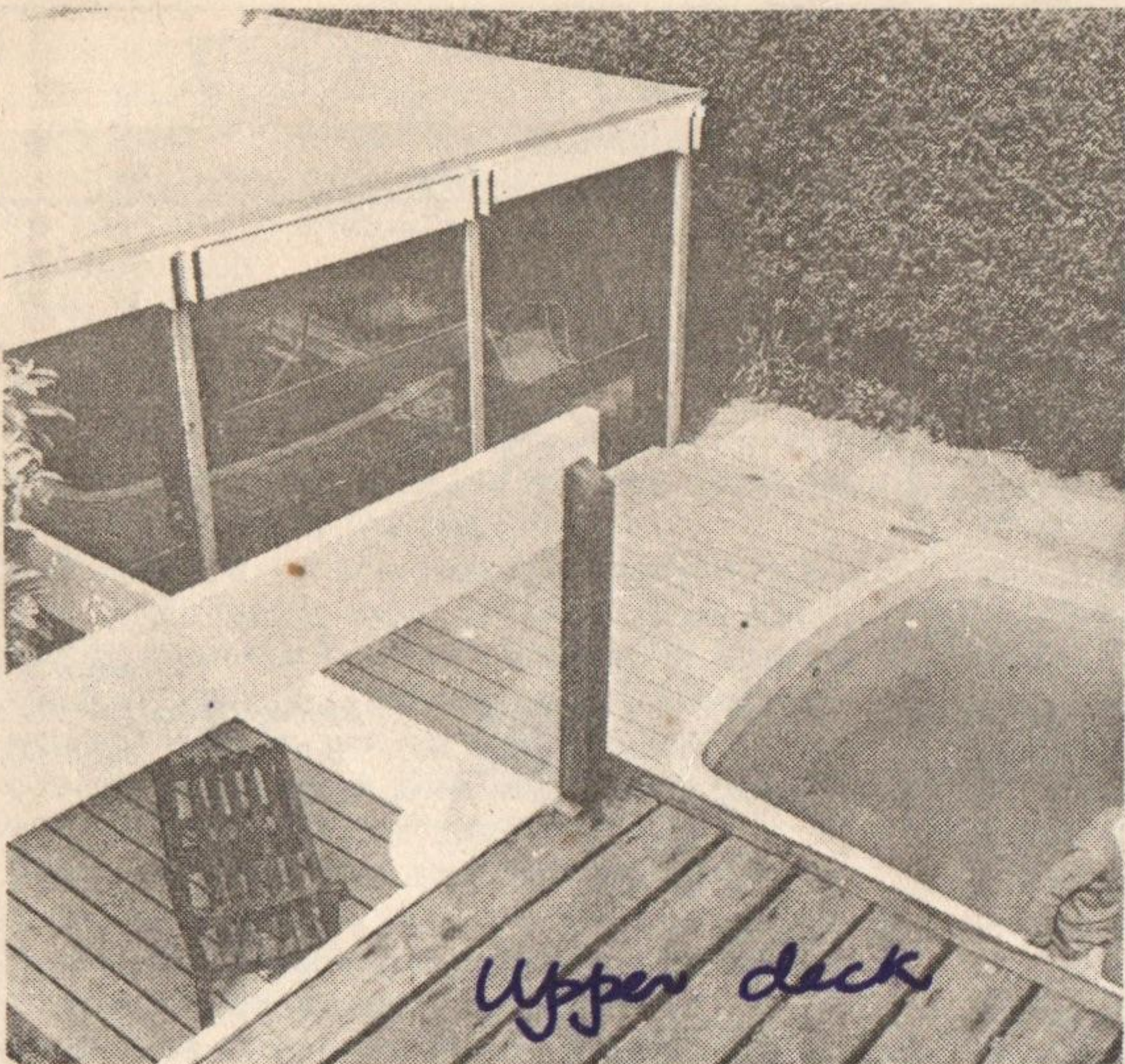
2 parents
2 schoolchildren
1 grandparent





These plans still have too much 'sterilized' space for too much of the day - this would not be so bad if the house was internally self-cleansing (This is being currently investigated in the Housing Study)

Can empty houses be used at such times as small schools for re-educating bored adults?



Dressing table with foldaway desk in mirror

62	32	A15	22	11
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Childrens Pavilion Worthing

Simple timber construction with additive detailing. Sizes scaled down (pavilion ceiling height 6ft 3ins) and anti-adult elements introduced such as narrow steep stairs to upper deck. Single piece fibre glass swimming pool lifted by crane over adjoining property on to site. Children helped in construction work. Proximity of sea affected choice of materials. Maintenance notes given to children — the real clients. (See also 11.9.63).

Comment

Not too bad but a bit precious and far too long lasting. The 'children' are now grown up. It would be interesting to undertake a new infill job on the grid of 3" x 3" structural timber columns (see details) — additive detailing enables such exercises (C.f. computer centre).

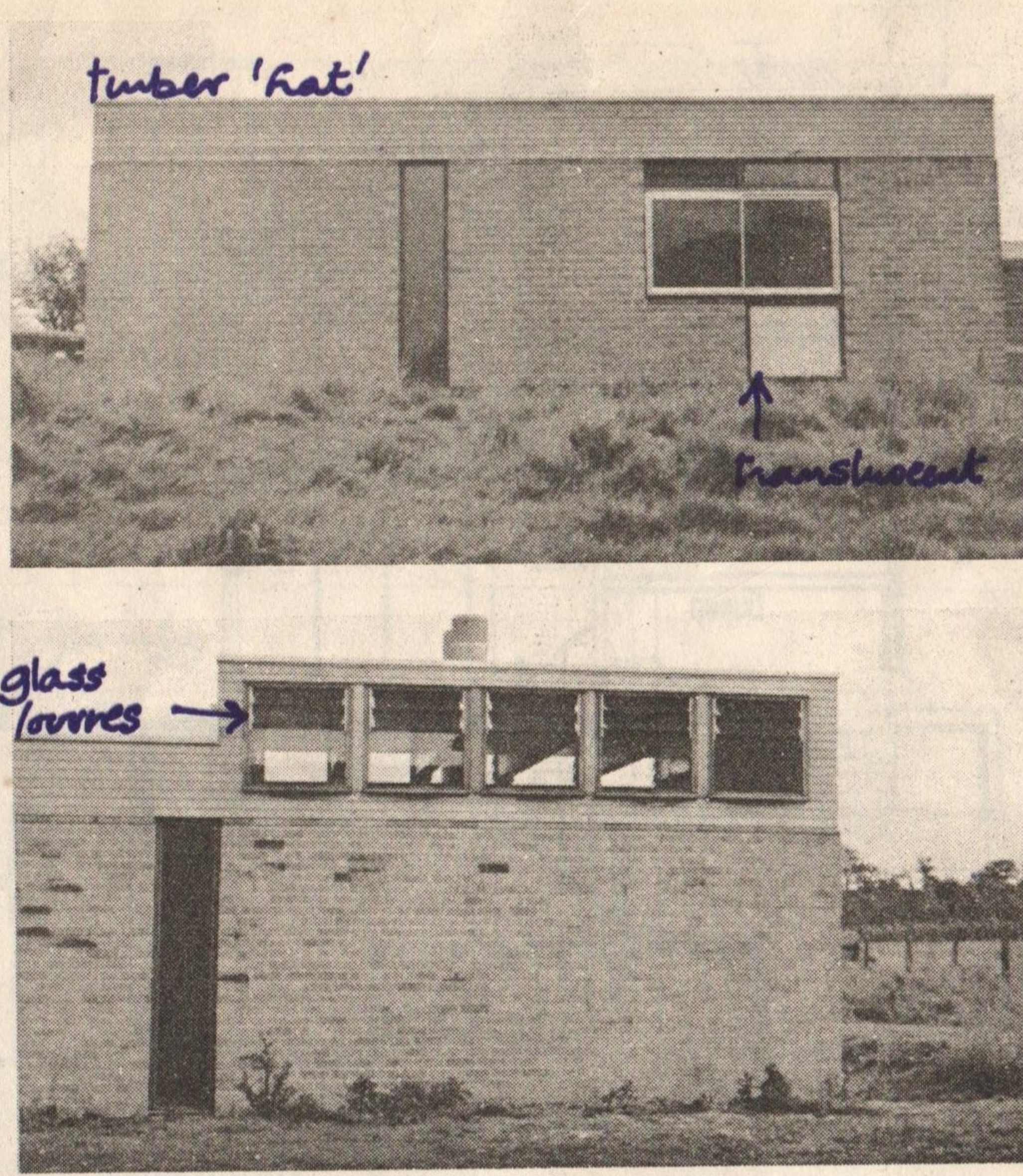
62	56	AC3	23	10
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Childrens Furniture Worthing

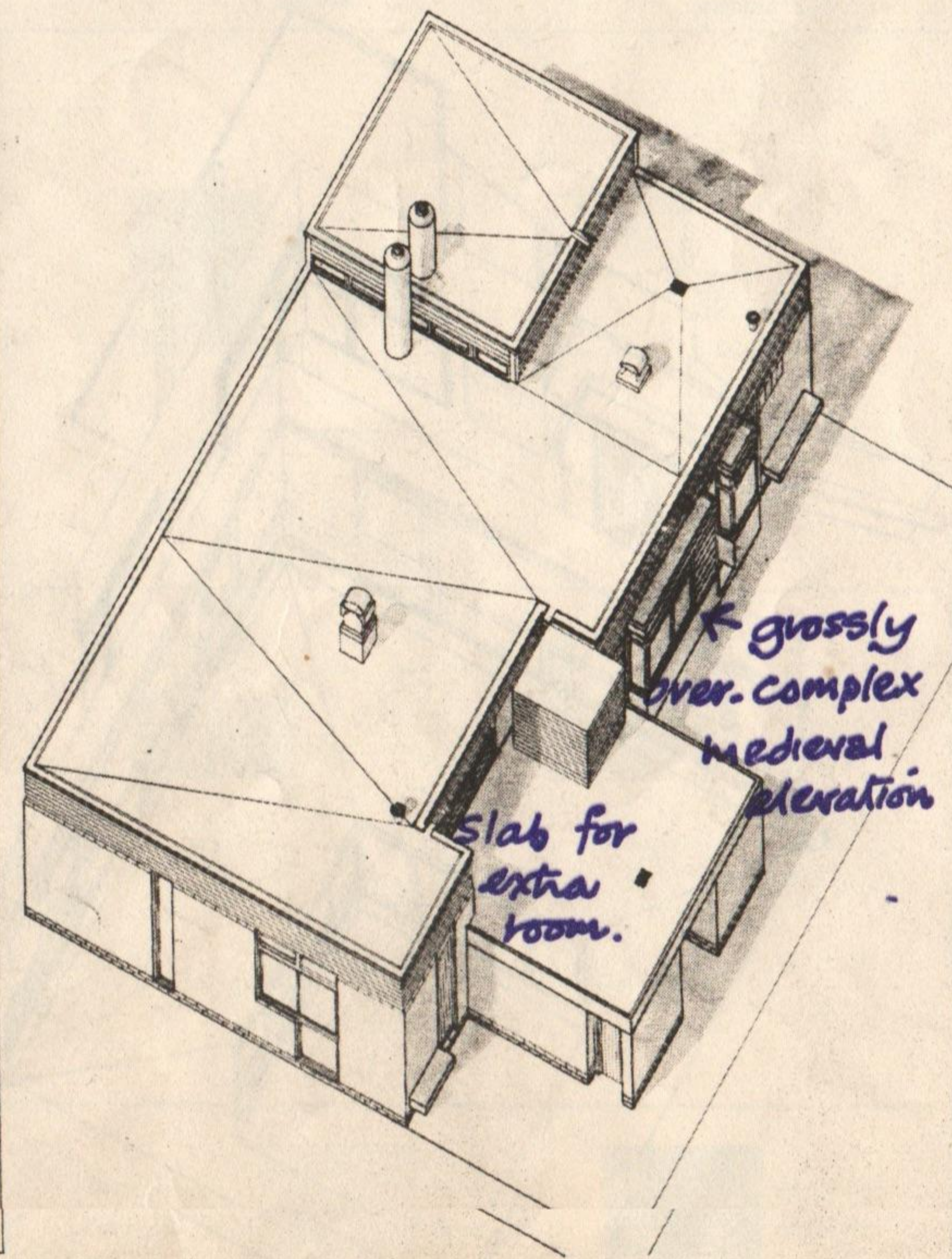
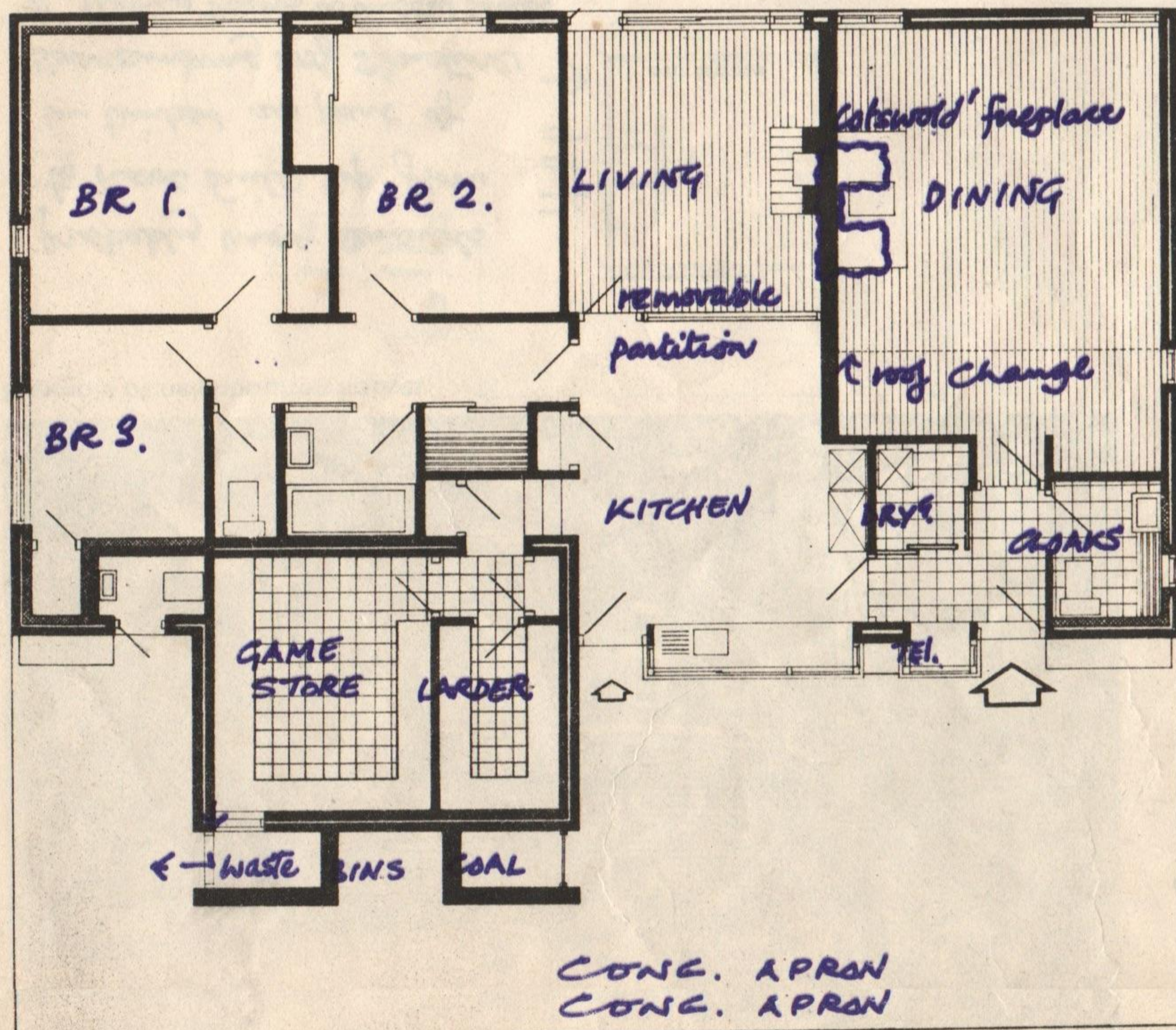
The same extremely intelligent clients — parents and children — as for the Pavilion. This time a range of sleeping, working, washing, dressing and storage activities had to be accommodated in such a way as to leave a working toy for the children to play with and alter. Dexion slotted aluminium angle hardwood, self-lubricating nylon drawers and spring loaded blinds are the major constituents.

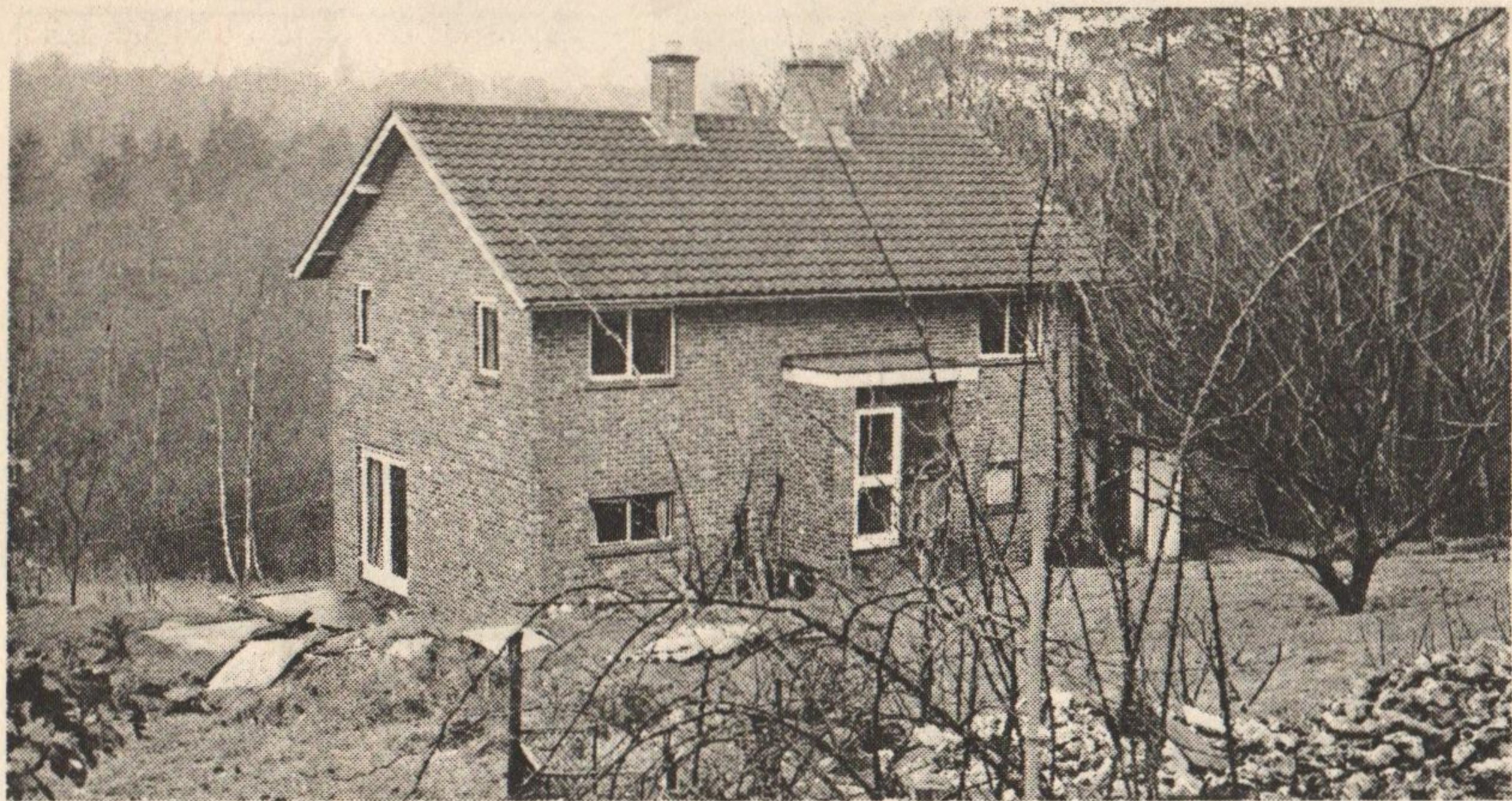
Comment

Individual units rather too 'purpose made'. A reasonable assessment of ratio of initial cost to likely life span and part re-use. An alternative to the self-assembly kits now on the market, where, each piece is purpose designed and dependent on the rest of the kit being of the same 'alphabet'.

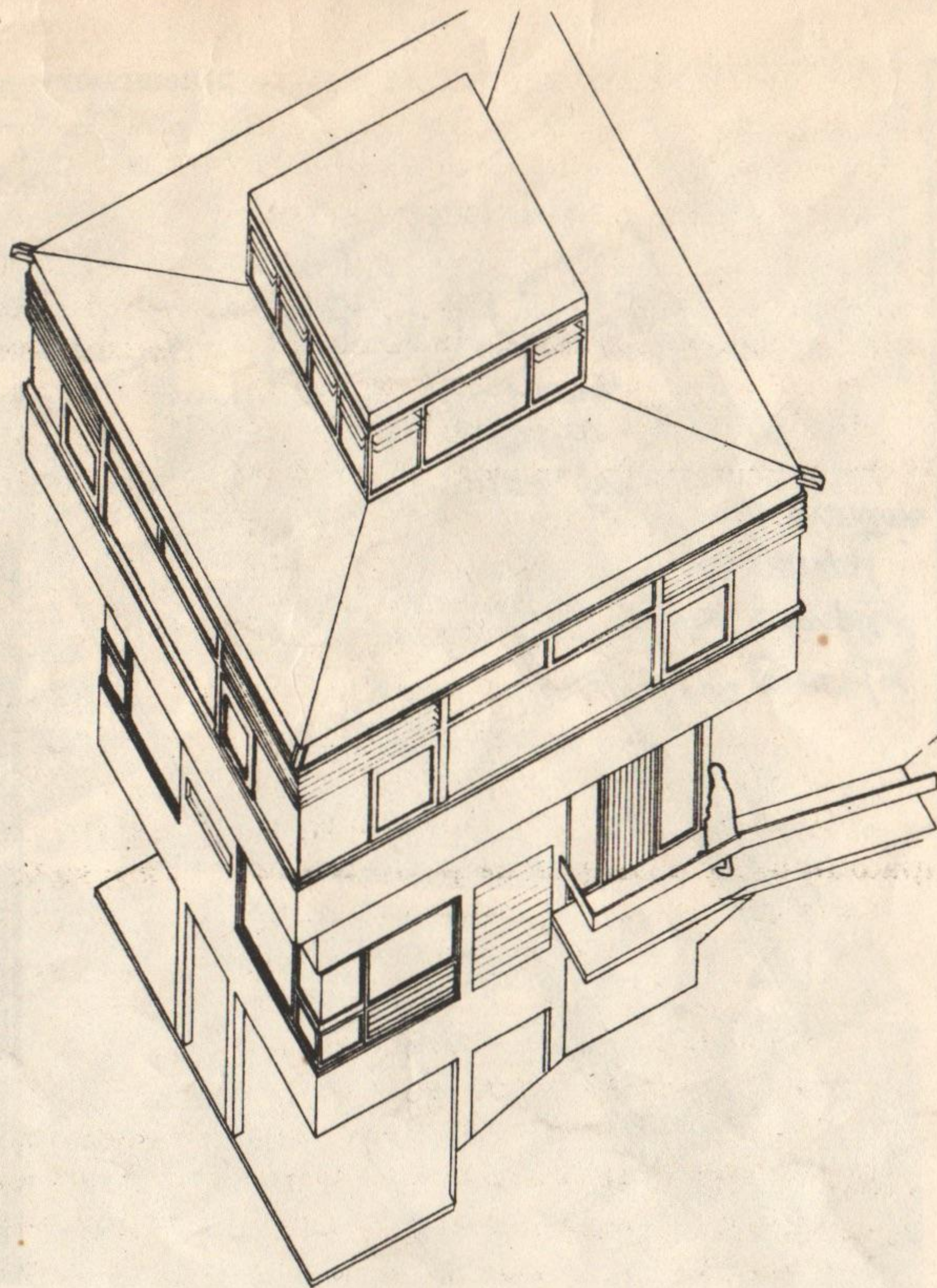


61	28	D5	24	9
Pheasantries, High Legh				
A house for the gamekeeper combined with washing and eating facilities for the shoot to replace an existing crumbling lodge. Cheap materials (concrete brick, timber roofs, lintels and fascias) combined with simple construction enabled a small local builder to contract, the cost being £5 12 per sq ft for 1200 sq ft. This price included electrical underfloor heating throughout, three separate wc's, a 10'6" high dining room, an elaborate drained semi-basement game store, concrete apron and site works including a septic tank. A damp site required total insulation to the heated floor slab. Natural ventilation on this exposed site was by means of numerous high level adjustable louvres — glass in the dining room, timber elsewhere.				
Comment <i>My first and last purpose-made private house to be built. Since its completion the gamekeeper and his family have left and the owner, single male, has moved in. Various jolly things have happened. Most of the louvres have been replaced by fixed glazing or nailed up. The free-hanging circular stack flue with hood to the main fireplace has grown a Cotswold stone surround while the 12 ft long 3 in thick oak and stainless steel strap table and settle have been cut down to size — in half in fact. The extension has not yet been built — if it ever is, it will be designed by someone else or, preferably, be chosen from the pages of "Greenhouse Weekly". My demolition of the mouldy little lodge produced the normal outcry from Society's mentors for the traditional dross. However, this building runs the risk of lasting too long — a major design fault both of siting and detailing. Indeed as motorways and other anti-game-bird activities approach I imagine the client wishes he had paid for something less permanent if not more mobile.</i>				



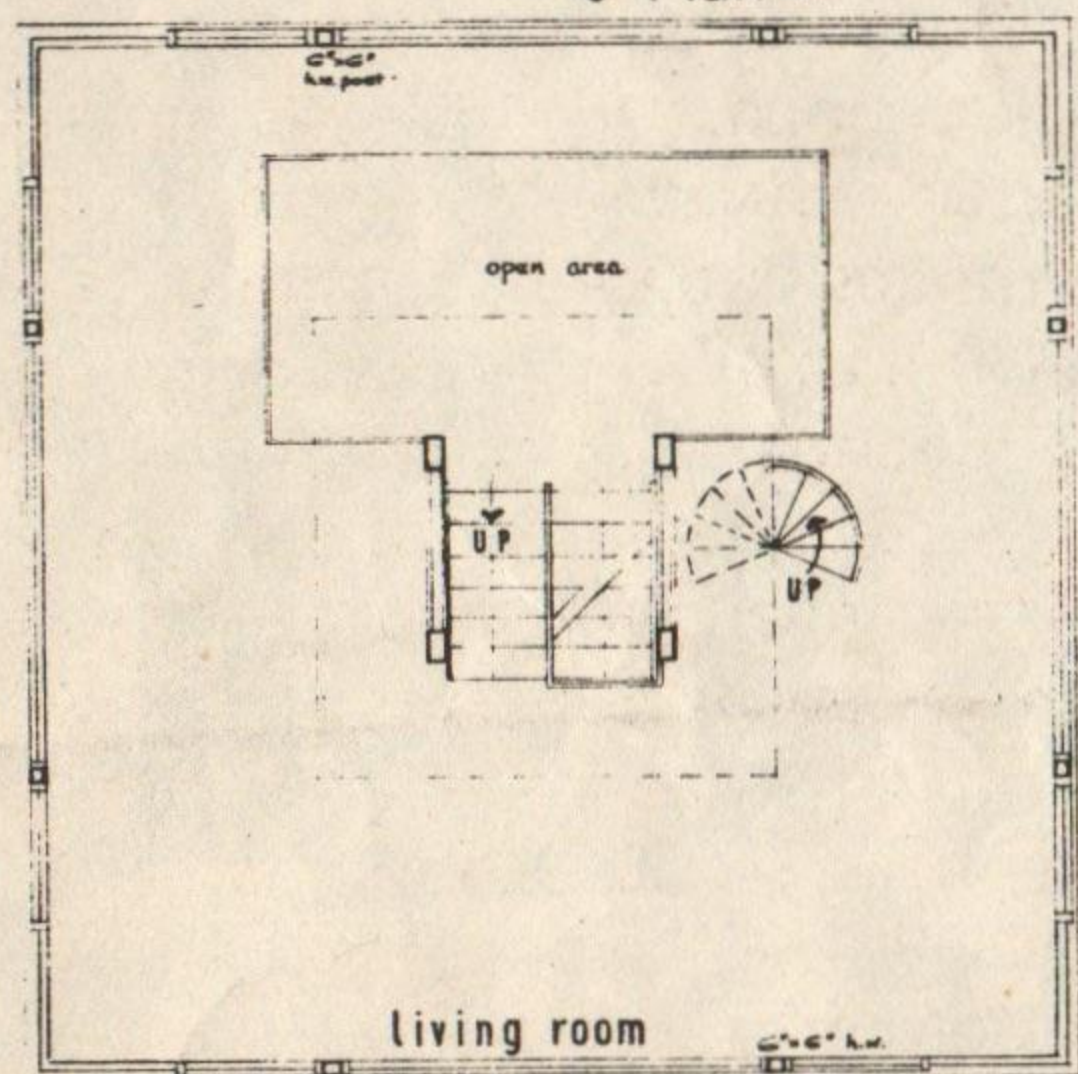
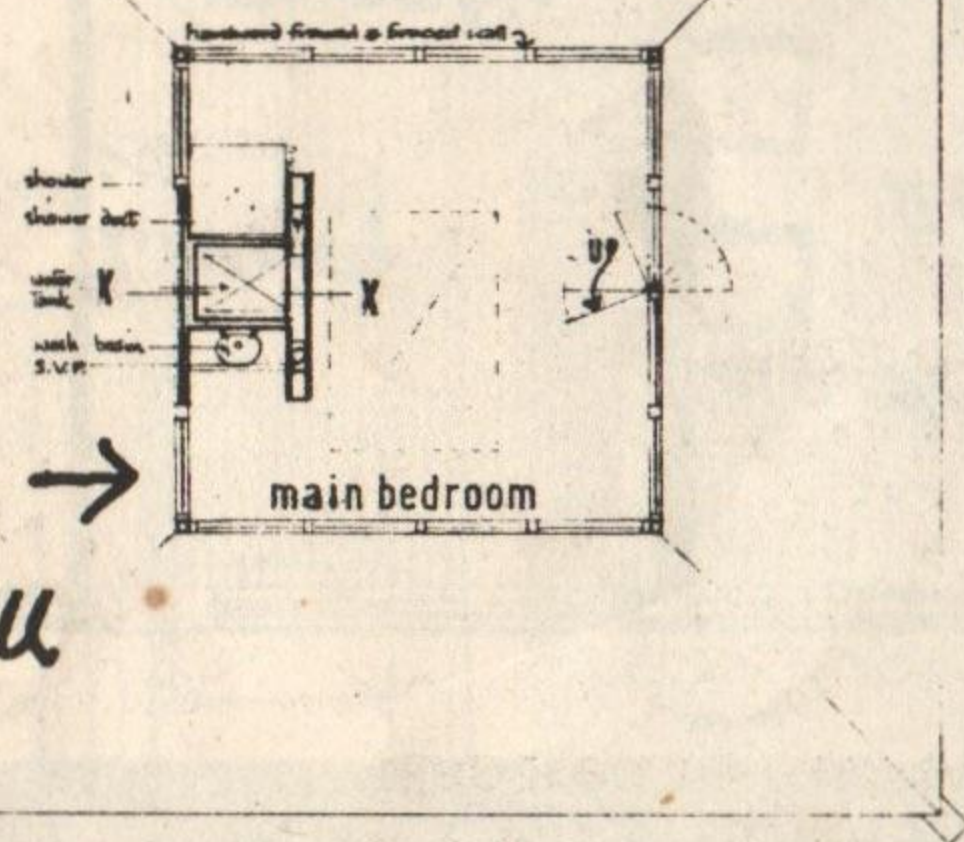


Example of neighbouring houses

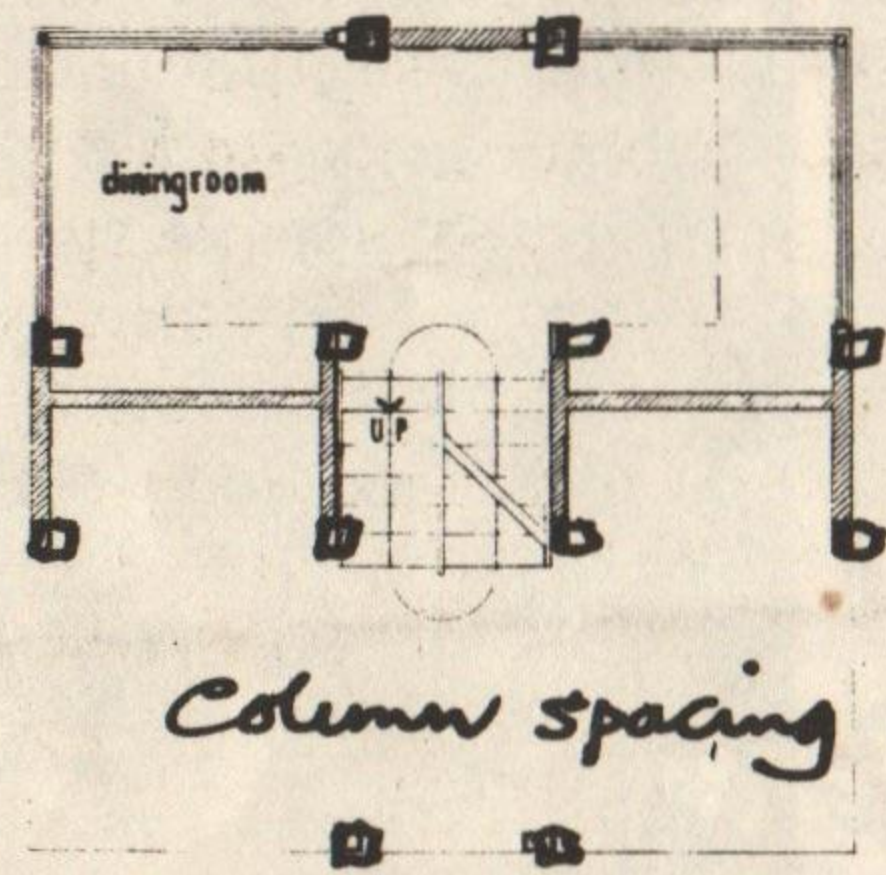


Axonometric

probably more sensible
to have built top floor
in timber as part of
surrounding roof structure →
& living room window wall

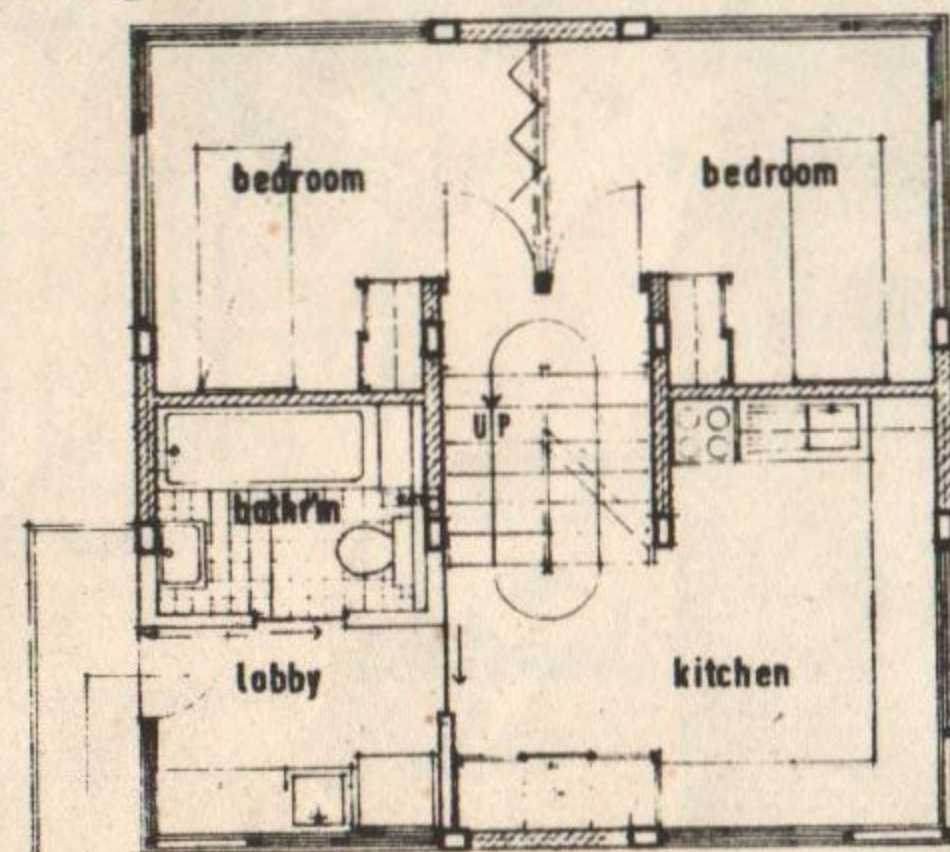


Plan 3

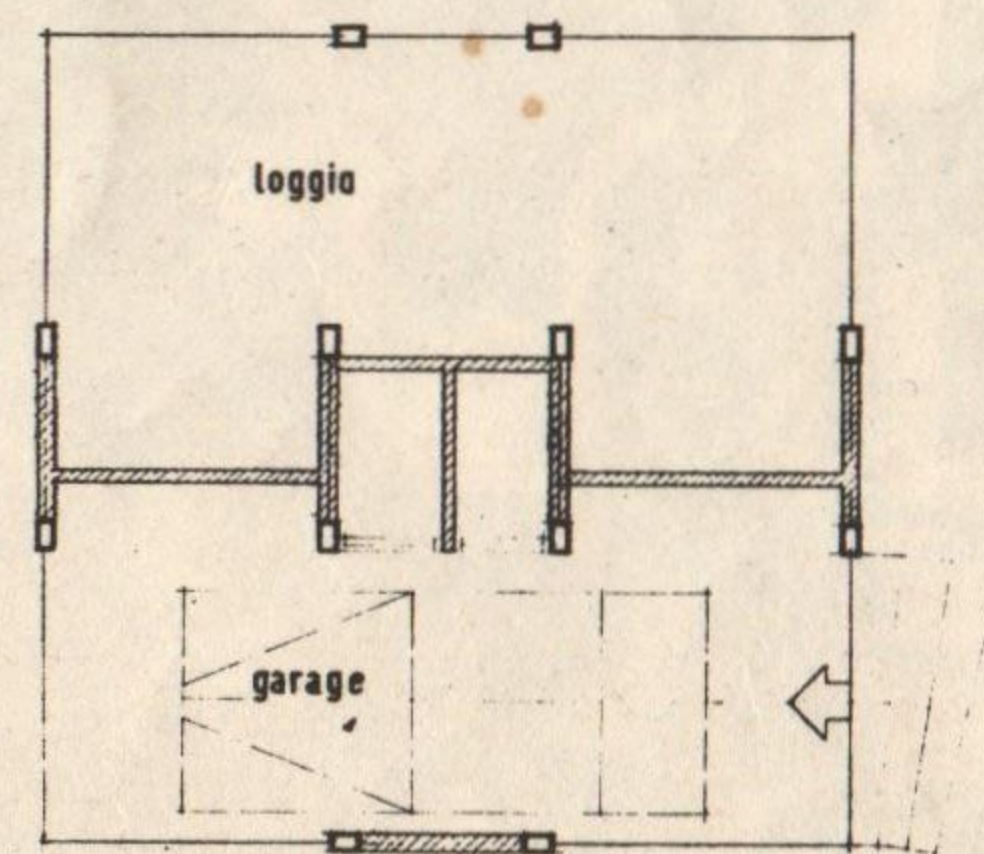


Plan 2a

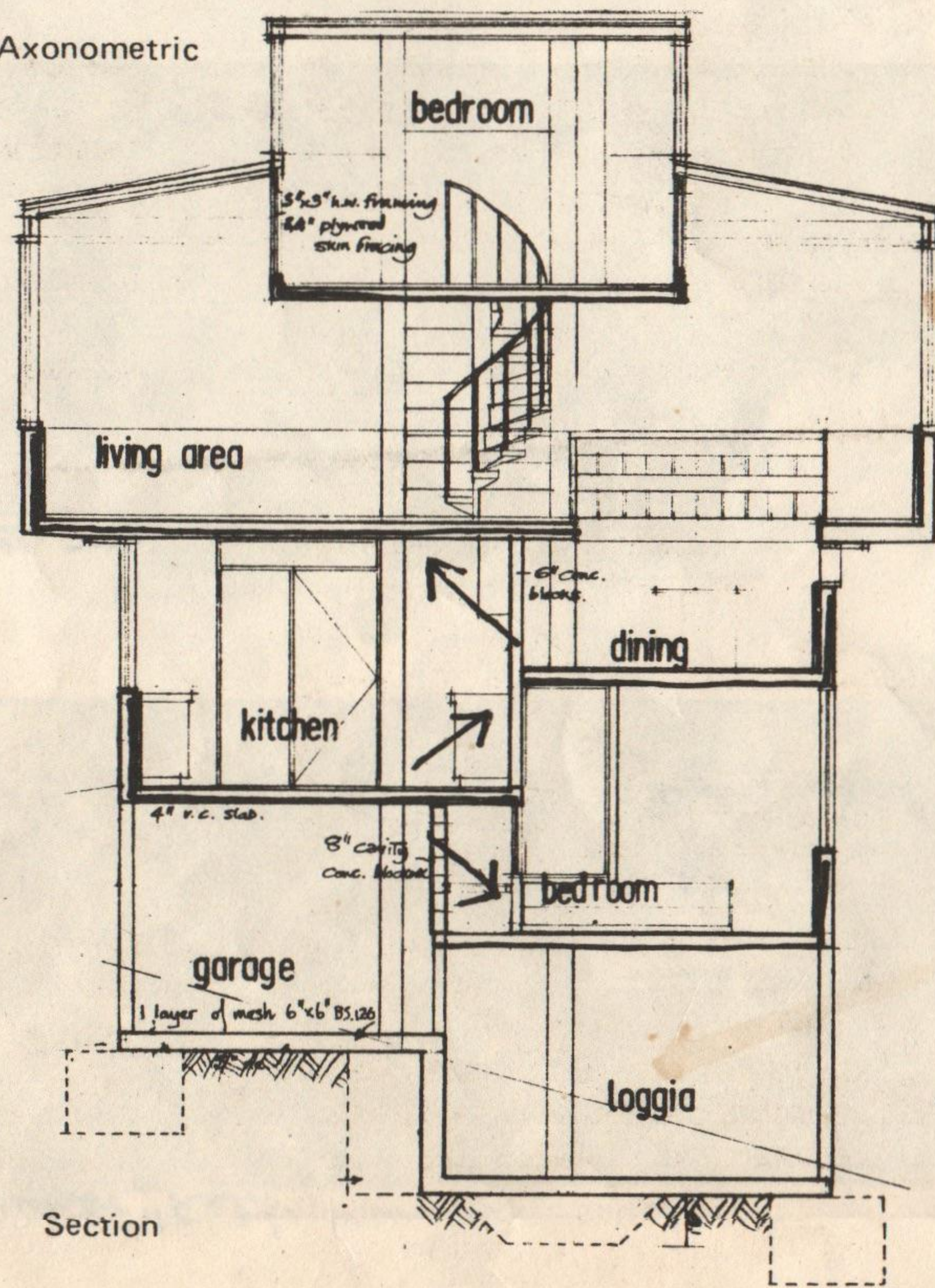
Column spacing



Plan 2



Plan 1



Section

62	35 X15	D15 D35	25	8
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House, Selsdon, Surrey.

A family house on a sloping site with fine views and trees. Construction consists of a series of interleaved reinforced concrete trays support by in-situ columns. Apart from some concrete block infill, all infill internally and externally, glazed and solid, consisted of standard ship joinery sections assembled in a ship yard. The sections selected, due to brilliant standard weathering details, enabled a large tolerance to be acceptable in the concrete work — the major on-site item. Hinged wall units were detailed to enable furniture to be put by crane directly to the appropriate floor — a grand piano was required in the living area.

Comment

A simple unassuming bit of domestic whimsy which fell foul first of the local authority aesthetes and, at appeal stage, of the Minister.

Extract from local authorities planning refusal:

... "The Council did not consider the design of this dwelling to be appropriate to the site having regard to the character of the surrounding area and the application was therefore rejected on the grounds "that it would be out of keeping with neighbouring properties and the rural setting of the area." ..."

Extract from Minister's dismissal of appeal:

... "The Inspector said that the site was on an open hillside amid unusually fine and wild landscape in the approved metropolitan green belt and he considered that it would be far better left in its natural state. However, most of the other dwellings in Beech Way were in the area allocated for residential purposes and almost all stood amid trees. The proposed house would be one of a row of houses. The design with its muted colours, would in his opinion be more suited to an isolated position in the landscape but on this site it would appear as an uncomfortable neighbour ..."

"Obviously the muted colours loused the whole thing up".

In a large proportion of middle-income houses in the U.S. and Western Europe storage space exceeds space devoted to human beings. Such storage includes that for cars, garden furniture and leisure equipment.

Park Hill housing in Sheffield England — a major local authority mass housing project, built less than ten years ago — is already wholly incapable of accommodating the motor car.

The French National Association of Family Allowance Funds and the Centre for Research and Information on Consumption reported on 4th July 1967 that 27% of families of town dwelling French wage-earners are badly housed.

With the advent of total availability of information and feed-back facilities — a situation almost in existence (e.g. National Computer Grid) — education and learning will be available to all, and will become for those beyond school age, primarily a home-based activity. With the shorter working week and reduced retirement age more of the family will spend more time — probably at home — on self-paced learning.

In 10-15 years' time a major activity of the young will be to teach their elders new tricks. The resultant educational hardware, work surfaces if not work spaces and storage, will make additional demands on domestic space.

Short-sighted concern on the part of architects and designers with the detailed ergonomics and operational space requirements of short life domestic equipment has resulted in the building of domestic areas — particularly kitchens and small family homes — which, through their spatial 'made-to-measure' quality, are becoming increasingly restrictive if not yet totally unusable.

It is ironic that housing designed with less architectural attention in the '30s is likely to prove the more useful in the immediate future.

However, in a longer term (15-20 years) it must be realised that practically our entire mass housing stock will be considered by all — even architects — to be sub-standard and requiring drastic surgery or extermination.

If local authorities and governments do not provide new housing in sufficient quantity and variety (very important)

others will.

In 1965 — one third of U.S. housing costing less than \$10,000 was mobile housing. Since 1962 there has been a growth rate in mobile housing of 25%.

By 1970, low-cost U.S. housing will be completely dominated by the mobile home.

Already such firms as General Electric, Alcoa, General Motors and Krupps are investigating the provision of mass housing as a saleable commodity.

Housing must be viewed as a commodity — as objects such as shoes or books — worth keeping only as long as they are needed and capable of infinite variety.

It is worth remembering that one very seldom dies in the house in which one was born.

There need be no difficulty in the provision of housing becoming an increasing state or local government service.

Many services can be publicly run even if the objects they dispense are commodities capable of only limited life use by a single consumer. For example, the U.K. National Health Service is fully prepared to dispense false teeth without demanding that they be shared.

Architects and planners must realise that existing permanent housing, as indeed the entire built environment as it now exists, is a natural hazard to future development in just the same way as a swamp, a forest or a desert. It is easier to move a mountain than a cathedral.

Look at Delft — even if you wanted to, do you imagine you could obliterate it? Yet it has not been around as long as the sea that you are so efficiently eliminating, and it would cost less — unless, of course, you would want to replace it with a replica — that is the danger.

In effect, this production of replicas is what is being done when architects and planners graft on to old towns new developments which they imagine will do nothing more than enrich and make more wholesome the existing town.

19th century servicing — sewers, water supply, gas, refuse disposal, street lighting etc. — that is still the major invisible servicing grid of most of our towns. It is likely to be a more restrictive design discipline than that of a hitherto totally 'undeveloped' site. It is likely to be less relevant to 21st century aspirations also.

It should be noted that the loose talk by architects and others concerning the environment of, say, a particular housing scheme is no longer a key factor in the public's acceptance of such housing.

Ten years ago such snob slogans as 'learn to live in the way to which you wish you had been accustomed' were sufficient to sell rather doubtful middle income housing in London. They are not now.

Now, for the equivalent cost in the same area purchasers require a communal swimming pool, at least.

In the U.S. where they may well have their own private pools, a very popular new requirement is that there should be a communal yet private golf course. Imagine what that site layout looks like on paper!

A new housing estate is being built around a private airfield for use of residents and guests only.

What type of housing layout would one have for a private hover-port and what density of development?

And as people through economic independence and personal mobility will soon demand the same particular range of choice in rented property, renting a house for a limited period will become the equivalent of purchasing a short-life object.

And why is the state unable to fulfill this role?

Is national and local government housing merely going to provide next year's slums? If so, they will be rejected for the mobile home.

It is not irresponsible to turn one's attention, if an architect, from immediate slum clearance and other housing shortage problems, since architects produce artifacts so very slowly.

If we could produce more rapidly, then we could indulge in the luxury of concerning ourselves merely with the immediate future.

The housing examples quoted raise another valid social patterning appetite and that is the increasing delight in particularisation of activity and place.

At an even larger scale, what is the real value of Delft? What should be done to it?

I suggest that if there are sufficient dedicated historiophiles to delight in hobbling over its cobbles then it should be maintained and exploited for this

situation

67	X14	C35	26	X
Delft Seminar				
A transcription of an unscripted talk to the Delft International Design Seminar attended by Jos Weber, Archigram, Jim Stirling, Brian Richards and others.				
Comment				
Already a little old fashioned.				

particular use. I find it fine for three days but not for 365.

But why on earth bring light-industry in?

As for the University being expanded in a small medieval town — well, that is of the same order of lunacy as the expansion of Cambridge (see Potteries Thinkbelt).

Allied to the potential in future urban development of particularisation of activity and living modes is, of course, the particularisation of physical movement.

Such particularisation is made even more desirable as such forms of static communication as satellites, T.V., radio, telephone and lasers proliferate.

Thus it may make more sense to take all the transatlantic supersonic aircraft to Paris-Nord and distribute their passengers over Europe by air-bus.

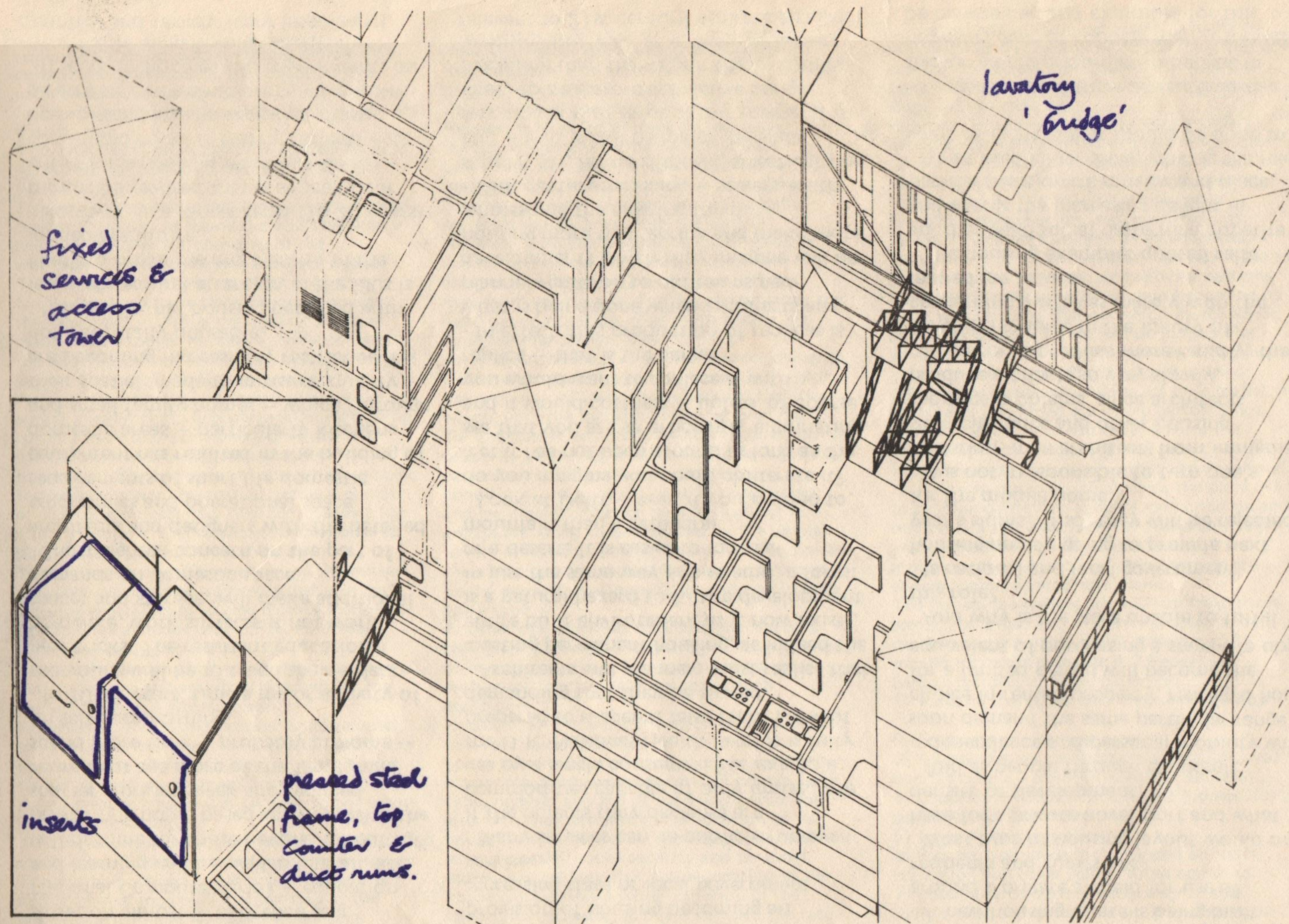
Certainly, it seems stupid to build any more large airports for merely one city, even London.

Unfortunately, airports appear at present to have replaced an army or a flag as a form of national prestige symbol.

At another scale, architects, planners, engineers and designers must avoid the danger of paying too much attention to present demands in the design of new forms of physical transportation lest their concern reduces the potential of the system to encourage its wider range of application and social exploitation.

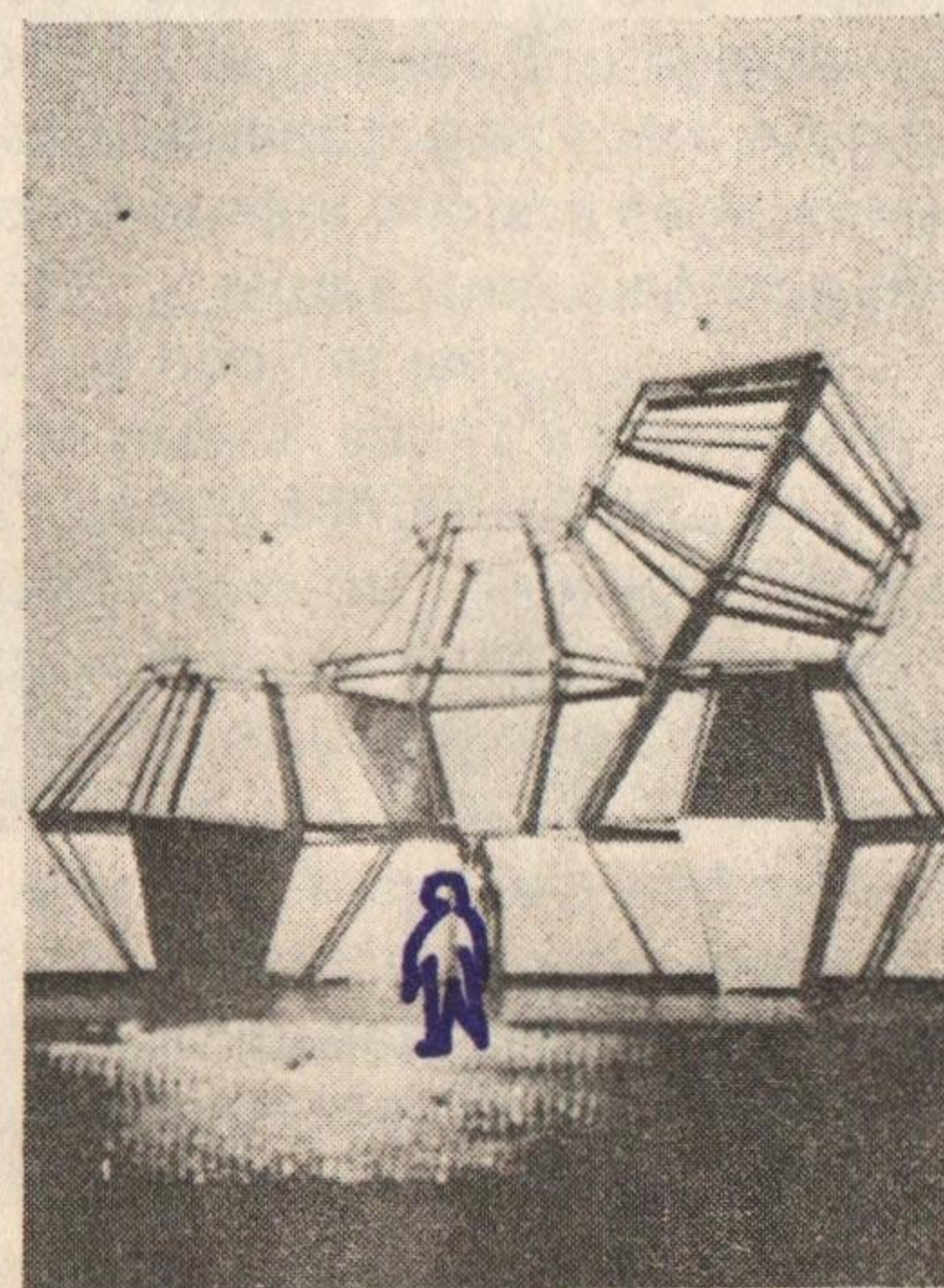
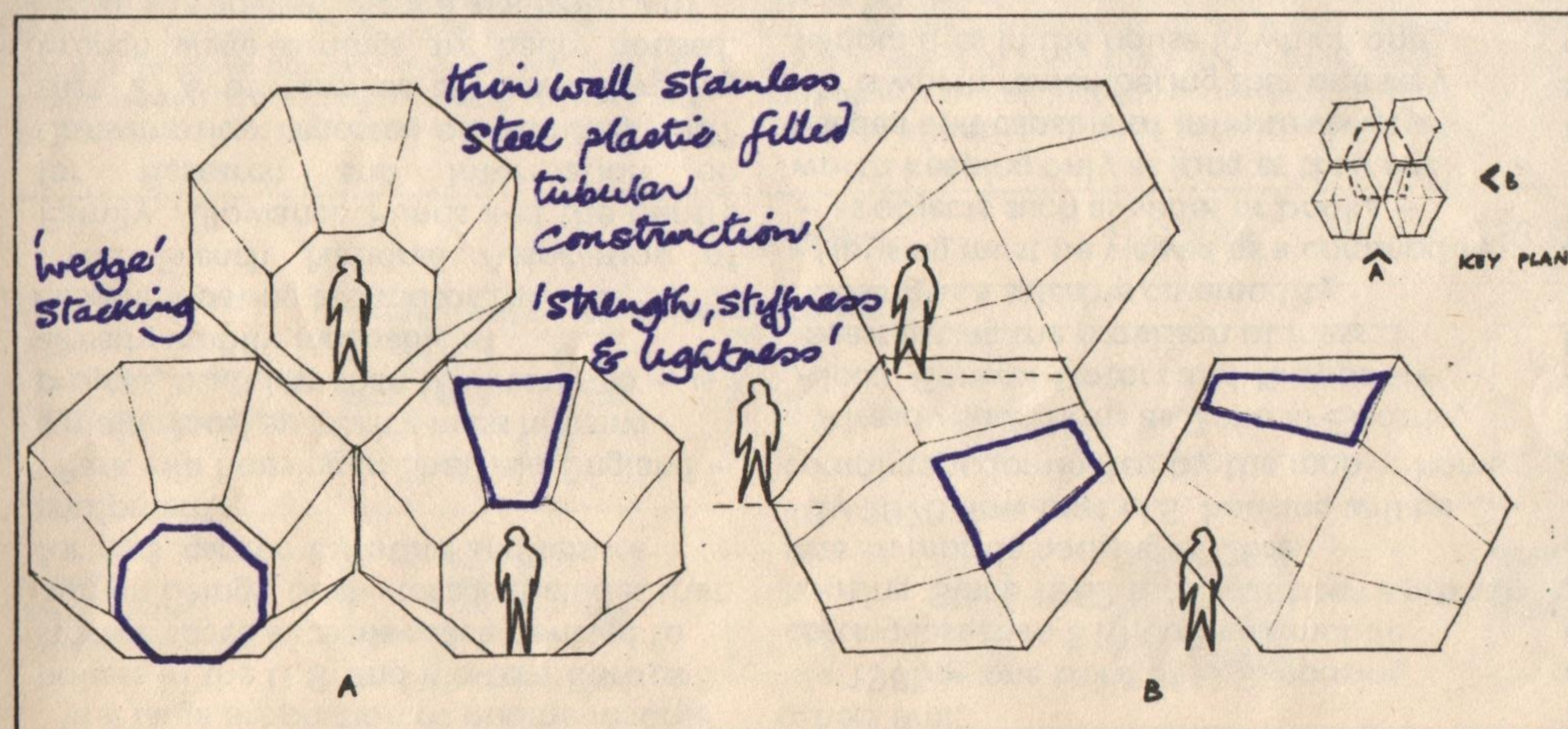
Finally, I suggest that for once we should see how little constrictive effect the more permanent aspects of our work need have, while at the same time investigating how much delight our short-term fixed-life products can give.

And the latter includes housing.



Kitchen unit

Axometric



61

51

D15

27 7

Fun Palace, London

Reinforced plastic units used on the human servicing side aisle platforms. Units build-up vertically and horizontally and can contain transparent inserts. All major servicing is through the steel deck units. Standard stairs lead to double-decker self-braced lavatory units on line of external towers. (See also Architectural Review January 1965.) The pressed-steel food preparation magazine enables varied standard kitchen units to be interlinked and connected to deck servicing.

Comment

The plastic unit system is almost a cartoon of all the short-comings of combining self-structured plastic units — limited individual versatility (eg maximum openings, minimum thickness) and mundane rectilinear combinations.

The food preparation magazine being a sloppier piece of detailing is clearly the more valid.

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7070
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A35

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Sheffield Festival

A prolonged and fragmented investigation into methods of enabling the citizens to play more with their city. An early proposal consisted of a series of these *gem* enclosures which would contain news and daily changing images. They could provide limited public shelter, warmth and light and would be strategically repositioned daily at 03.00hrs to maintain an element of surprise.

Comment

The "gems" which were to be illustrated by Felix Topolski were later replaced by proposals to work on the existing city structures in a less formal way. Heights to be written on buildings, bus routes altered, river decorated etc. Joe Tilson and others were involved. Unfortunately, Festival organisers whether in Brighton, Bath or Sheffield are uniquely gloomy group and scarcely worth bothering with.

Wokingham Primary School Competition

Joint submission with Christopher Grillet (Lyster Grillet and Harding as now) concentrating on the realisation of the fact that this was the first *home-alternative* experienced by the 5-7 year old users. Their *own front door*, yard and cloakroom was considered very important, as was the opportunity of meeting those of other ages (2 years difference maximum) at important collective times — like eating, singing or sporting. Cheap construction (c.f. High Legh timber 'hat') and the obliteration of circulation/corridor areas kept the cost low.

Comment

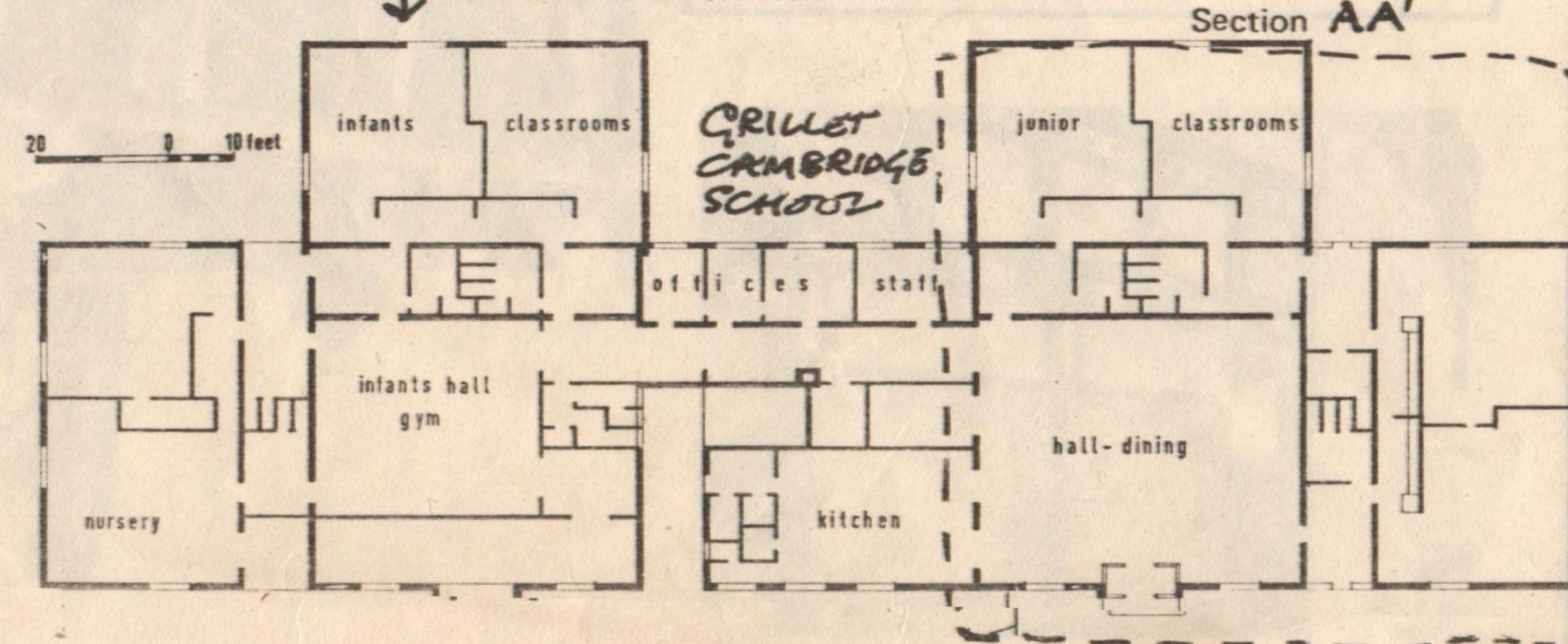
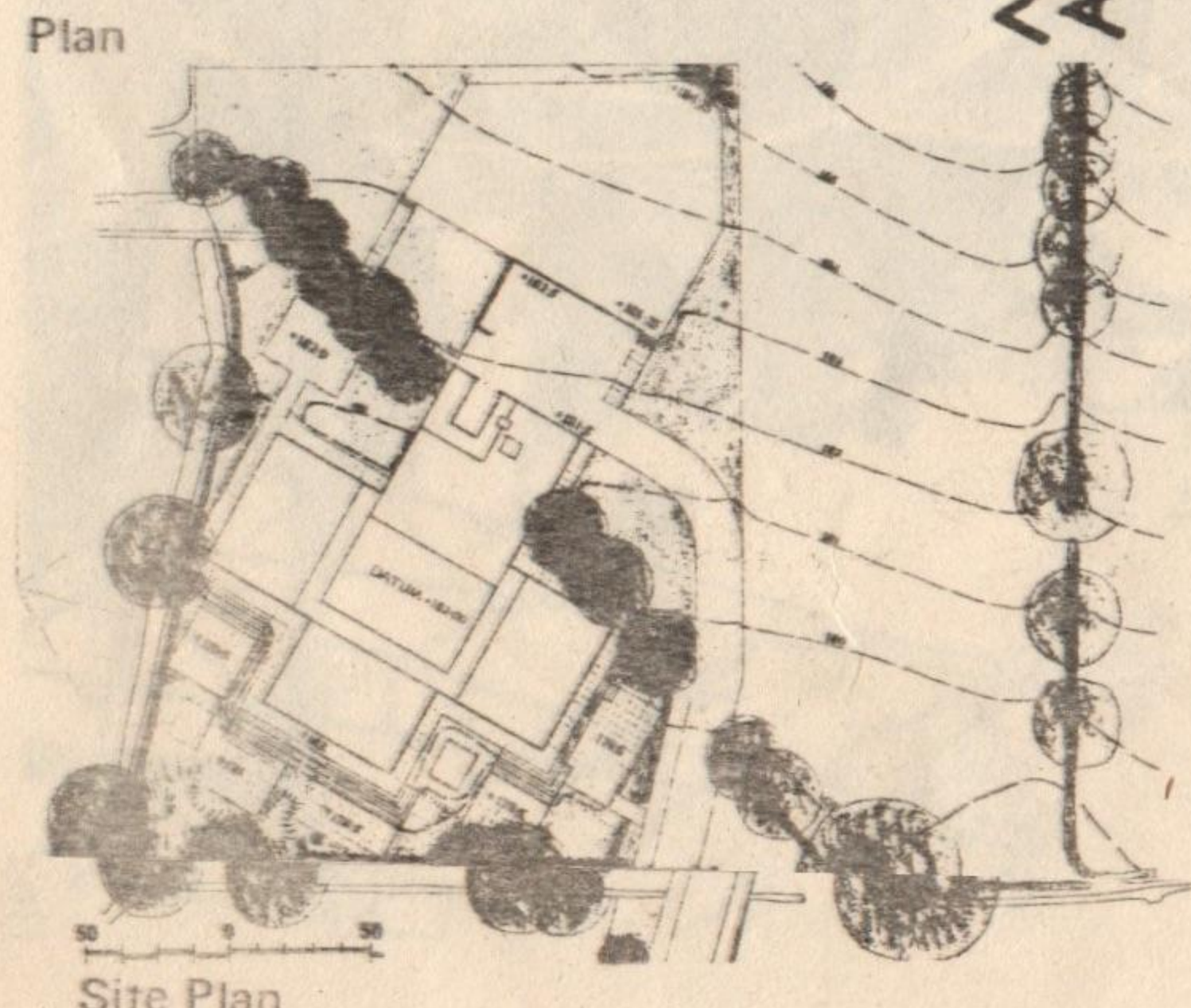
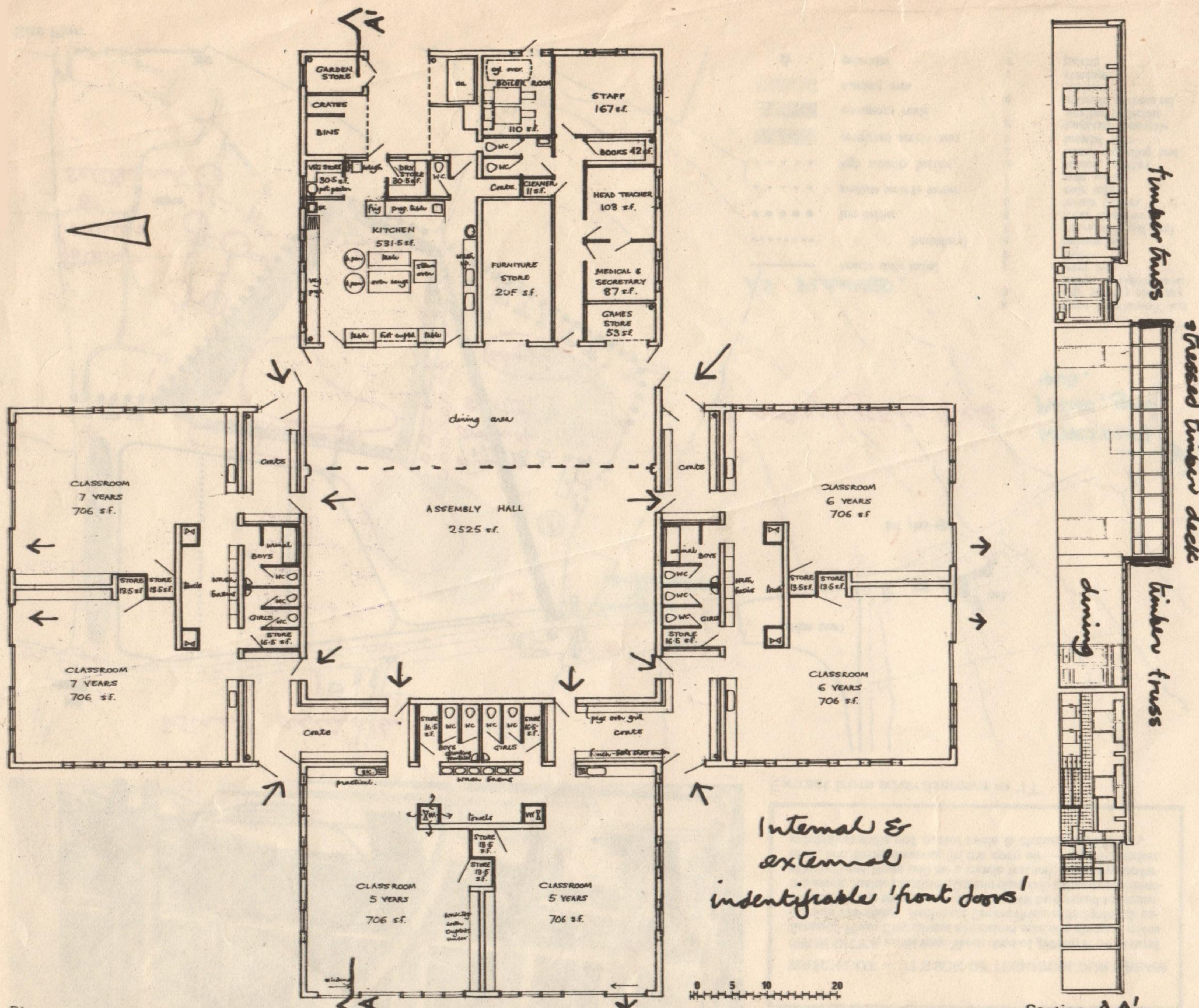
One of the cheapest entries together with the delightful "lean-to pavilion" entry by the Smithsons. A conceit in brick and timber and a childish belief in the permanence of compulsory education produced this friendly pudding of a building which was later echoed by Grillet at Cambridge. Primarily it was a revulsion from the fragmented whimsical planning of contemporary schools.

Extract from EDUCATION Feb 27 1959:

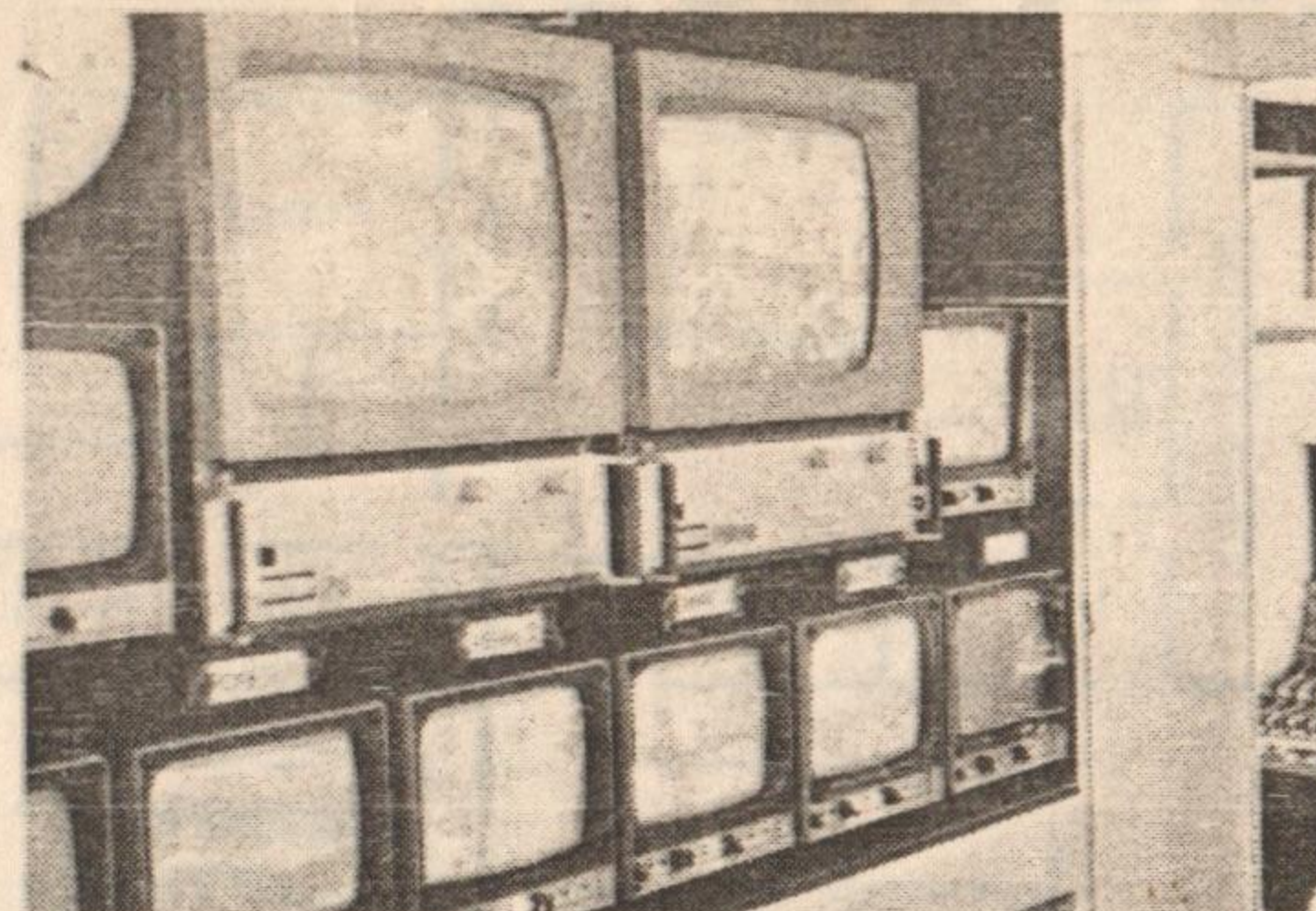
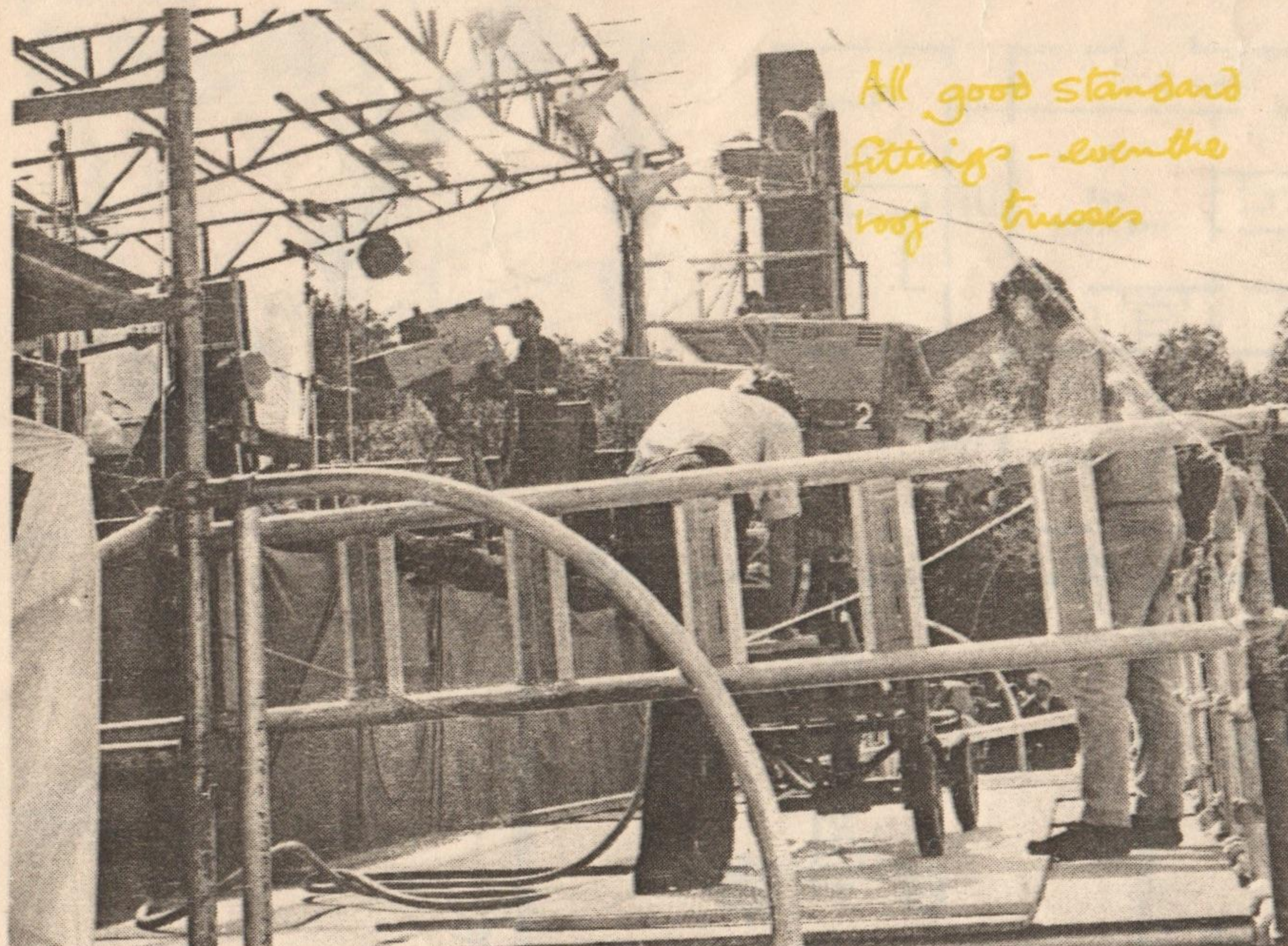
... "There is a real conflict here that has to be faced and resolved, and if we are to look for new contributions to the planning of infant schools we should, I suggest, look for new architectural contributions rather than increased services and layout.

Among the designs that make this form of contribution the cruciform plan of Grillet and Price should be mentioned. A

rectangular hall with clerestory lighting forms the centre of the cross, and is used for dining and indoor activities. Opening off three of the walls are cloaks and classrooms for the three age groups, and off the fourth, kitchens and staff rooms. There is no wasted space, the hall providing cross-circulation, and also the main access for visitors. This building, together with the design by Peter and Alison Smithson, has a greater contribution to make towards functional architectural design than most of the others. Incidentally they are amongst the cheapest designs submitted ... "A great little mag!"



Section AA'



SOUND + VISION + TIME DELAY - the time client

WATCH OUT - IT'S SON OF TECHNICOLOUR DREAM

PHUN CITY is on its way. Three days of getting it on in rural Sussex. / Phun City covers a hundred acre site about 4 miles outside Worthing. Architect Cedric Price is designing & co-ordinating the temporary city that will be erected to house the event. Inside plastic inflatable domes & other experimental structures there will be a movie festival, a poetry conference, and theatre events. In the open air - a giant market, exhibition stalls and motor cycle & chopper exhibition.

Extract from advertisement in 'IT'

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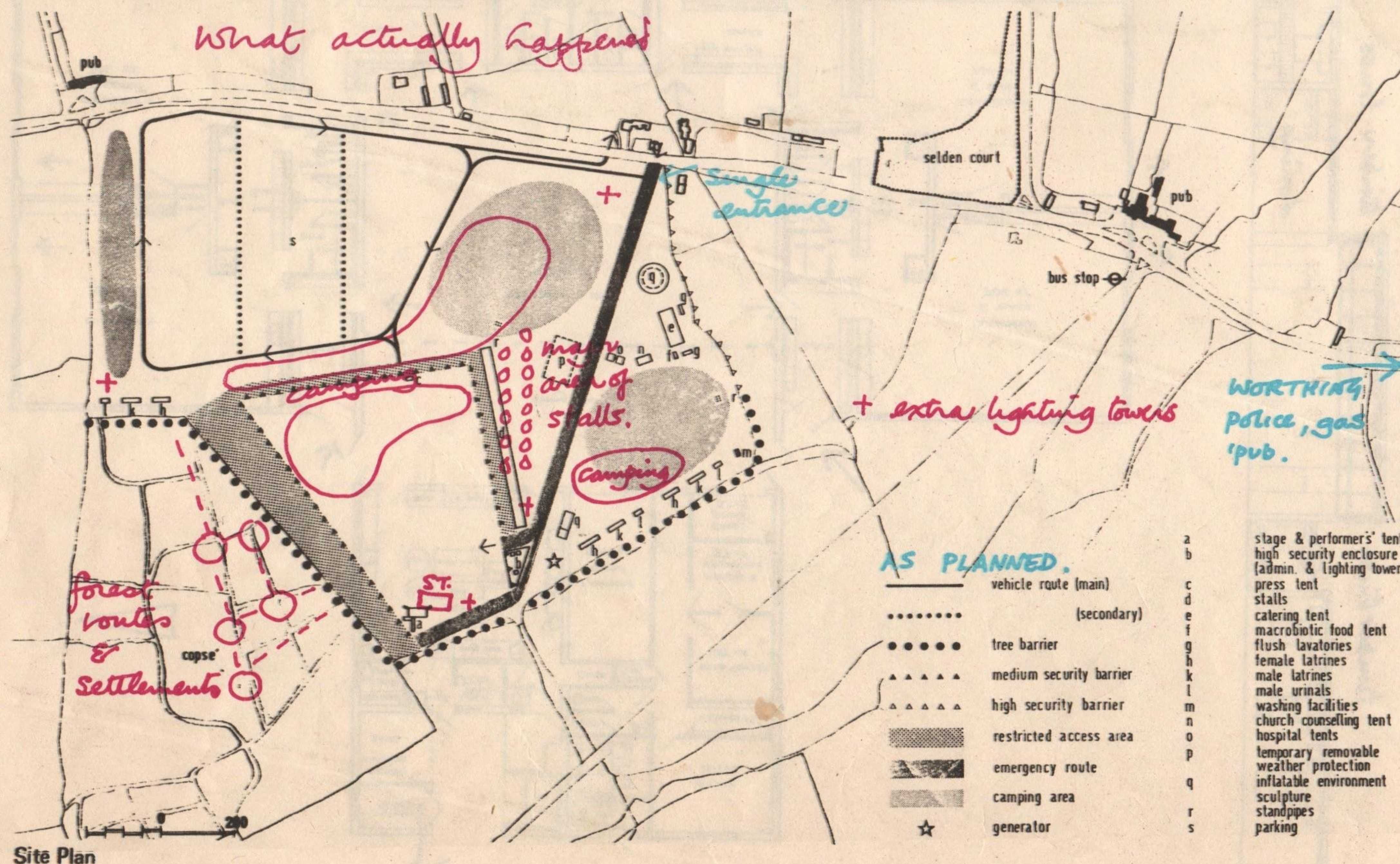
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Phun City

60 acres of rolling Sussex countryside was chosen as site for a self-help pop festival - in summer 1970. A well drained, beautifully sited piece of land. After initial coolness, co-operation with the transport, health, fire and police authorities became friendly and fruitful. The co-operation with local business interests was also satisfactory during the design period. The phrase "social engineering" became valid for once. Scaffolding was hired, tents and air structures promised while siting and number of lavatories was agreed. Priorities of purchase, siting and construction were agreed and then, a few days before opening local clever legal sabotage all but wrecked the lot (See AD 11/70). Estimated cost of works allowing for resale and a majority of free labour £5,000. Estimated day population 15,000.

Comment

Shortage of cash and foul weather totally altered the assumed physical and operational nature of the "city". Film rights became more important than the sale of tickets resulting in a reinforced stage and the abandonment of a controlled entrance arena. Also lack of collective shelters encouraged the extremely hospitable arborial shanty-town which lasted after the festival. A case of where 'Non-Plan' (merely securing the land and co-operation of authorities both for a limited time) might have worked better than the informed paternalism we adopted. In fact, the financial shambles almost ensured the former. Mick Farren, my client, led the anti-establishment at the Isle of Wight Festival one month later. We all learnt something.



Site Plan